SKULBASE USER GUIDE

Administrator guide

For principals, deputy principals, directors of studies and school administrators

Everything needed to set a school up on Skulbase and run it through the year: the school's calendar and grading, the modules it runs and the duties staff hold, classes and subjects, staff, learner and parent accounts, choosing the exam being marked, marks and report cards, attendance and its reports, fees and who owes, messages to parents, and promoting learners at the end of the year.

Contents

1. Getting started

- Register your school
- Activate your account with an invite code
- Sign in
- Finding your way around

2. Your dashboard

- Reading the dashboard
- Across the school
- The setup checklist

3. Setting up the school

- School profile and report card details
- Academic calendar
- Grading systems
- Classes
- Subjects and subject teachers
- Choose what your school runs (modules)
- Give staff their duties
- Online fee payments (optional)

4. People and accounts

- Add learners
- The Add student form
- Import learners from a spreadsheet
- Staff and accounts
- Give parents their own login
- Staff and parents directories

5. Exams and marks

- Choose the exam being marked
- See who is behind on marking
- Enter or correct marks
- Using the mark sheet
- Upload marks from a spreadsheet or a photo
- Release results to learners
- See a class's results
- Lock a finished term

6. Setting up exams

- Add exams to the term

7. Report cards and results for parents

- Generate report cards
- Text results to parents
- Compare terms

8. Attendance

- Take the daily register
- The whole school on one day
- Attendance reports

9. Fees

- The fees overview and health score
- Fee records
- A learner's fee account and statement
- Record a payment
- Receipts and checking one is genuine
- One payment for two children
- Bill a whole class at once
- Reconcile: matching every payment to a learner
- The day book: signing off each day
- Who owes, and fee reminders
- Following up arrears: notes and promises to pay
- Collections report
- The payments log
- A fee routine that keeps the books right

10. Announcements and homework

- Post announcements
- Writing an announcement
- Set homework and mark it

11. Analytics

- Reading Analytics

12. Other modules

- Where each module is explained

13. End of the year

- Promote learners

14. On your phone

- Using Skulbase on a phone

15. Getting help

- Where to get help

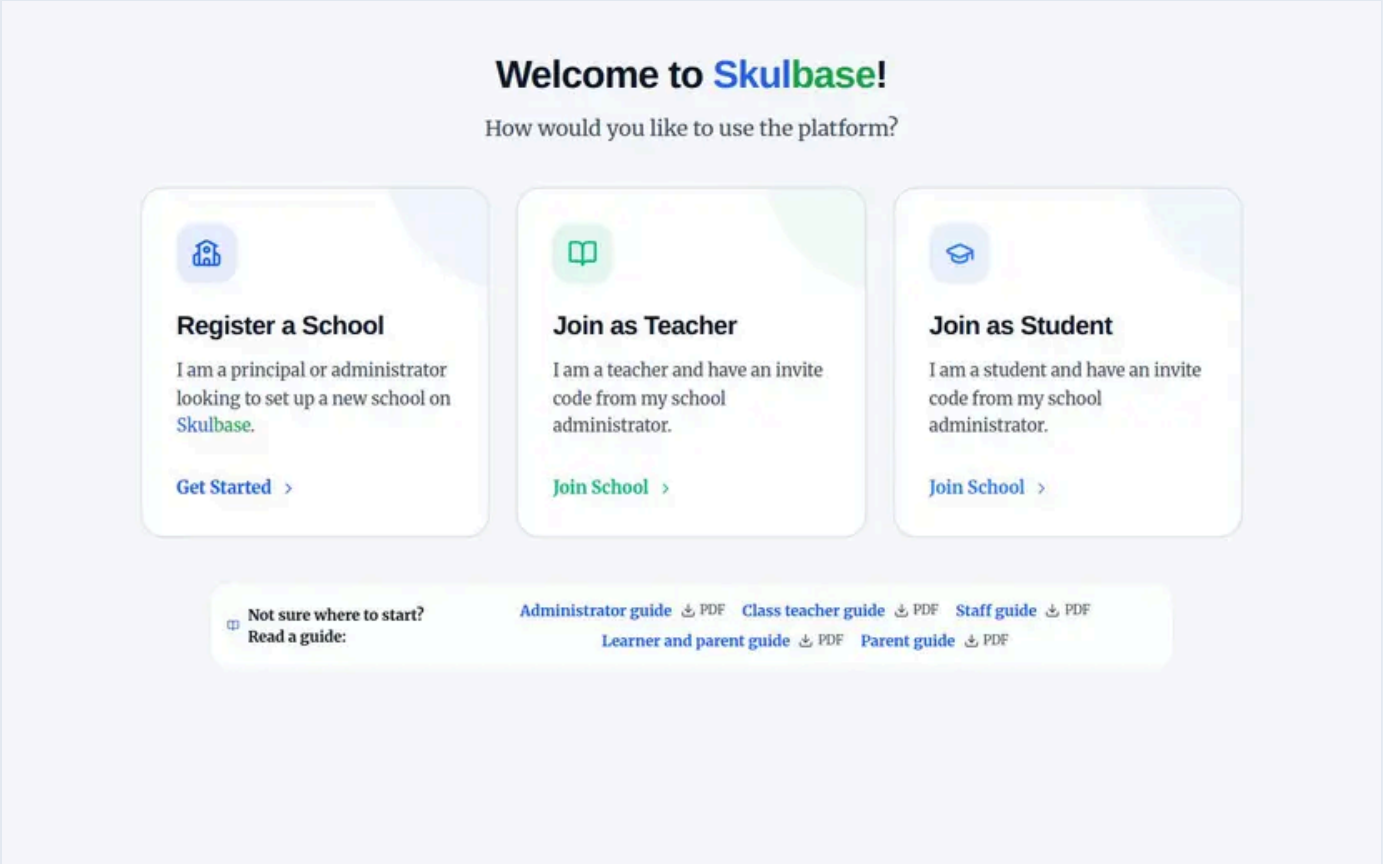
CHAPTER 1

Getting started

A school is set up once, by its administrator. After that, you add the people and everyone signs in with their own account.

1.1 Register your school

The first administrator creates a Skulbase account and registers the school. Skulbase then checks and approves the school before it goes live.



After creating your account, choose “Register a School”.

1. **Create your account**
   Go to skulbase.com and choose Get Started. Enter your name, email address and a password, or continue with Google.

2. **Choose “Register a School”**
   The welcome screen asks how you will use Skulbase. Teachers and learners join with an invite code instead; you are setting up a new school.

3. **School information**
   Enter the school’s name, email, phone number and postal address. These print on report cards and receipts, and you can change them later in Settings.

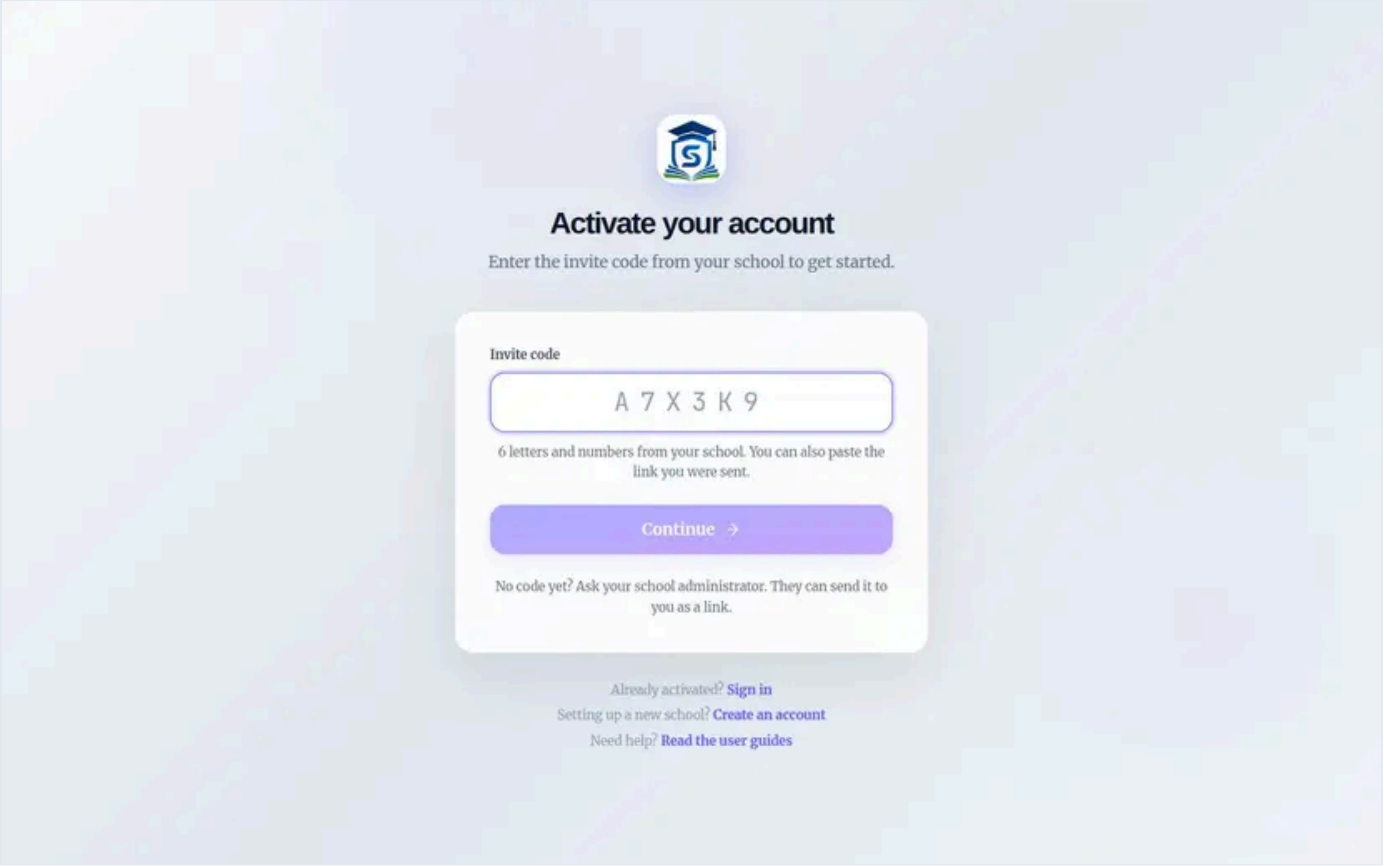
4 **Academic calendar**
Enter the current academic year (for example 2026) and the current term.

5 **Curriculum**
Tick every curriculum and grade your school teaches: CBC, 8-4-4, or both if you still have 8-4-4 classes. Only these appear when marks are entered.

6 **Wait for approval**
Submit the request. While Skulbase approves it you can “Explore while you wait” on a demo school to see how everything works. You are told as soon as your school is approved.

1.2 Activate your account with an invite code

Teachers, staff and learners do not sign up on their own. Your school adds you, and you get a personal invite code (or a link that has the code in it) to set up your login.



Activating an account: type the invite code from your school, or open the link they sent you.

1 **Get your code**
Your school administrator gives you a six-character invite code, for example A7X3K9, by SMS, WhatsApp, on paper, or as a link. The code only works for your account.

2. **Open the activation page**
   Tap the link you were sent, or go to skulbase.com, choose Sign in and then “Activate your account”. If you opened a link, the code is already filled in.

3. **Check it is you**
   Press Continue. Skulbase shows the name the school registered. If it is not you, choose “Not you?” and ask the school for the right code.

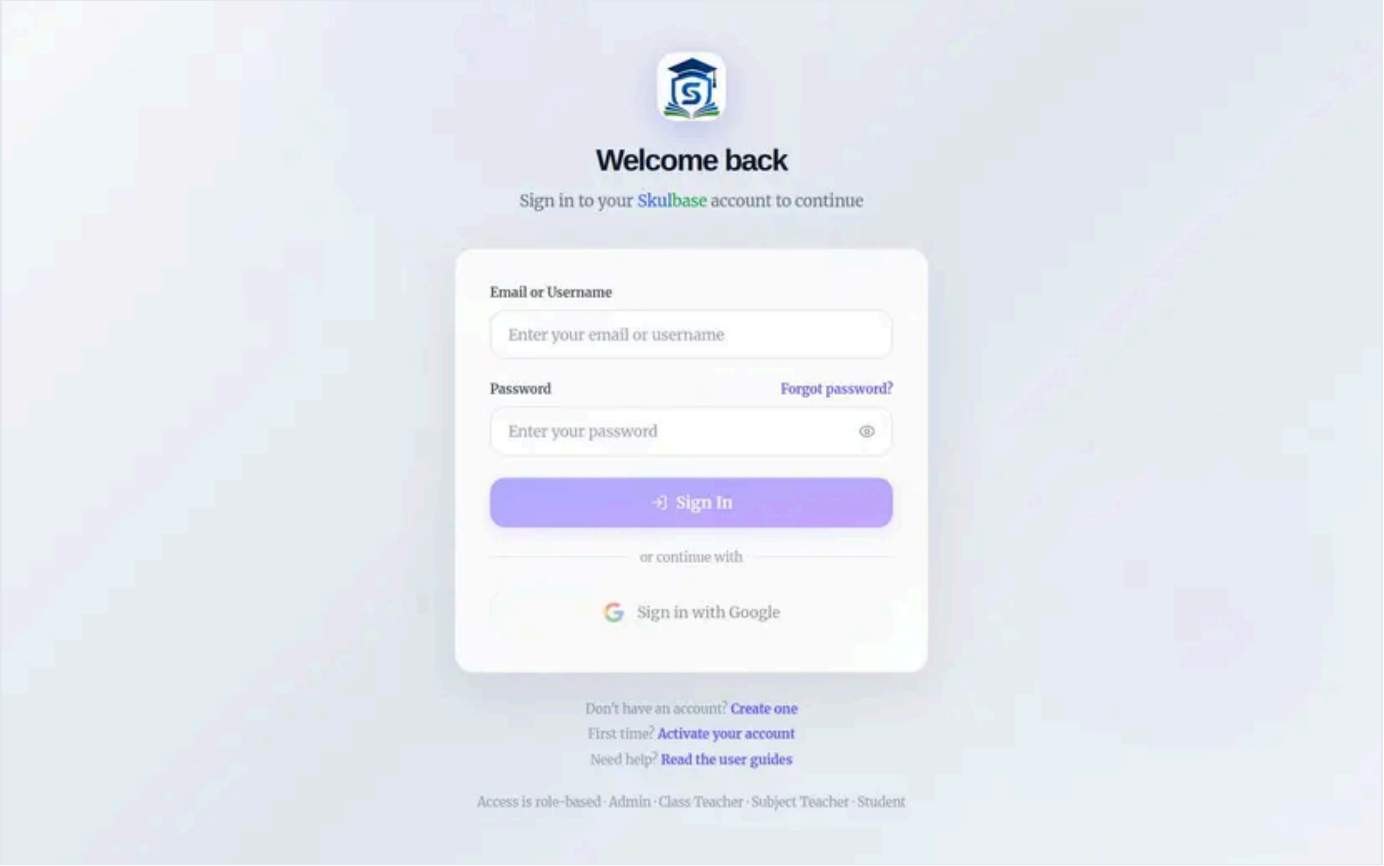
4. **Choose how you will sign in**
   Pick a username (one is suggested for you) and a password of at least 8 characters, or continue with Google. Adding an email address lets you reset your password yourself later.

5. **You are in**
   You are signed in straight away and land on the home page for your role.

> ⚠ **Good to know:** Each code can be used once. If yours says it has expired or was already used, ask your administrator to reset your account; they get a fresh code in seconds.

1.3 Sign in

Once your account is active, sign in with your email address or username and your password, or with Google if you activated with Google.



The sign-in page. “Forgot password?” sends you a code by email.

1. **Go to the sign-in page**
   Open skulbase.com and choose Sign in.

2. **Enter your details**
   Type your email address or username, then your password, and press Sign In. Or press “Sign in with Google”.

3. **Forgot your password?**
   Choose “Forgot password?”, enter your email address, and type the six-digit code we email you along with a new password. This also works if you have only ever used Google, and afterwards both ways work.

> **Tip:** Save skulbase.com to your phone’s home screen. It opens like an app and remembers you are signed in.

1.4 Finding your way around

The menu only shows the pages your role can use. On a computer it runs down the left-hand side; on a phone the main pages sit in a bar along the bottom.

- On a computer, the arrow at the top of the menu makes it narrower (icons only) or wider (icons and names). Skulbase remembers your choice.
- Press the / key, or tap “Search menu”, to jump to any page by typing part of its name.
- Your name at the bottom of the menu opens your account menu: switch between light and dark appearance, or sign out.
- If you hold more than one role (for example an administrator who is also a class teacher), use “View as” in the account menu to switch views.
- On a phone, the bottom bar shows your four most-used pages. Everything else is under More.

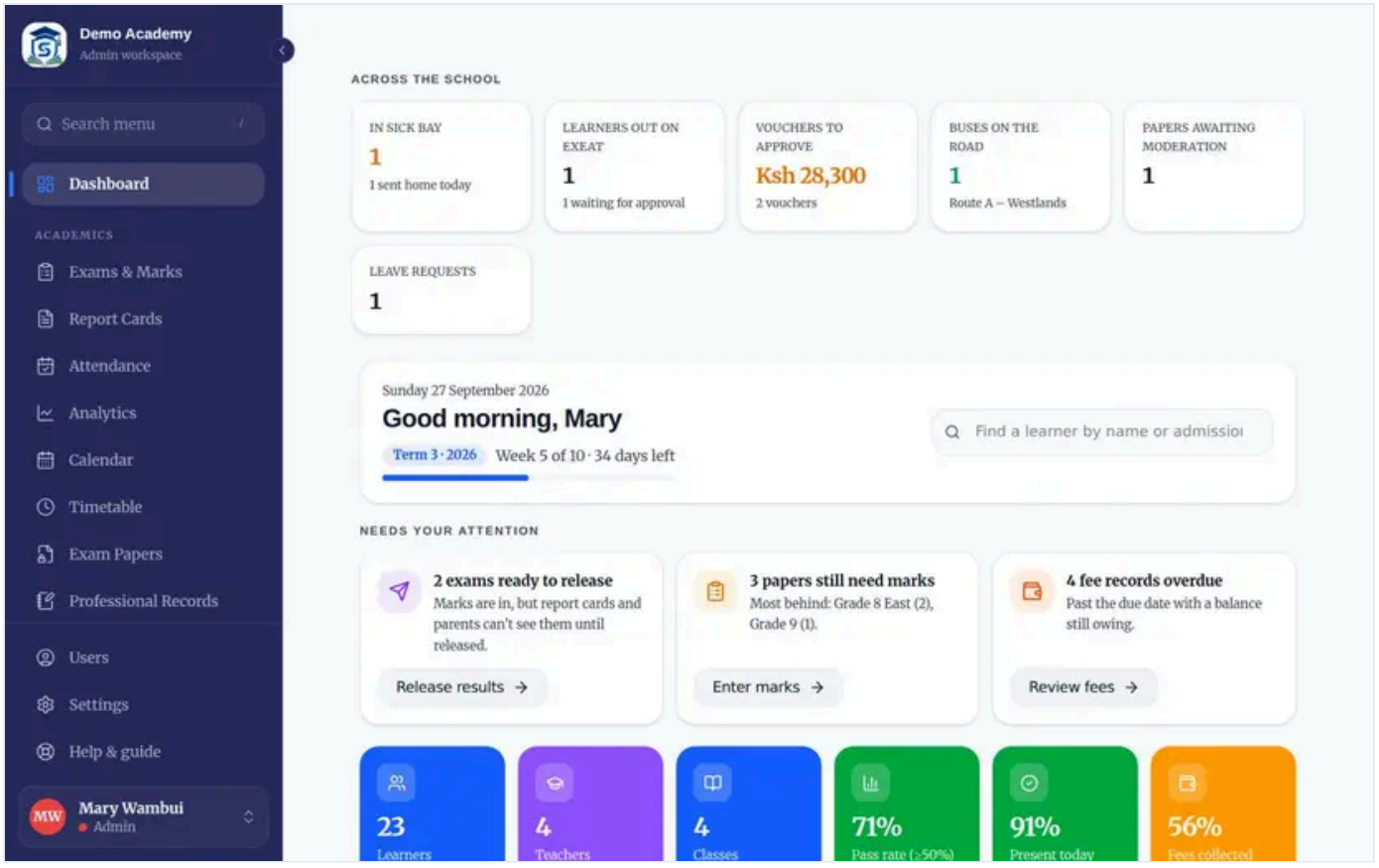
CHAPTER 2

Your dashboard

The dashboard is the school at a glance: where you are in the term, what needs doing, and the numbers that matter.

2.1 Reading the dashboard

The top of the dashboard says where the school is in its own calendar, then lists anything waiting for you, then the key figures and shortcuts to every common task.



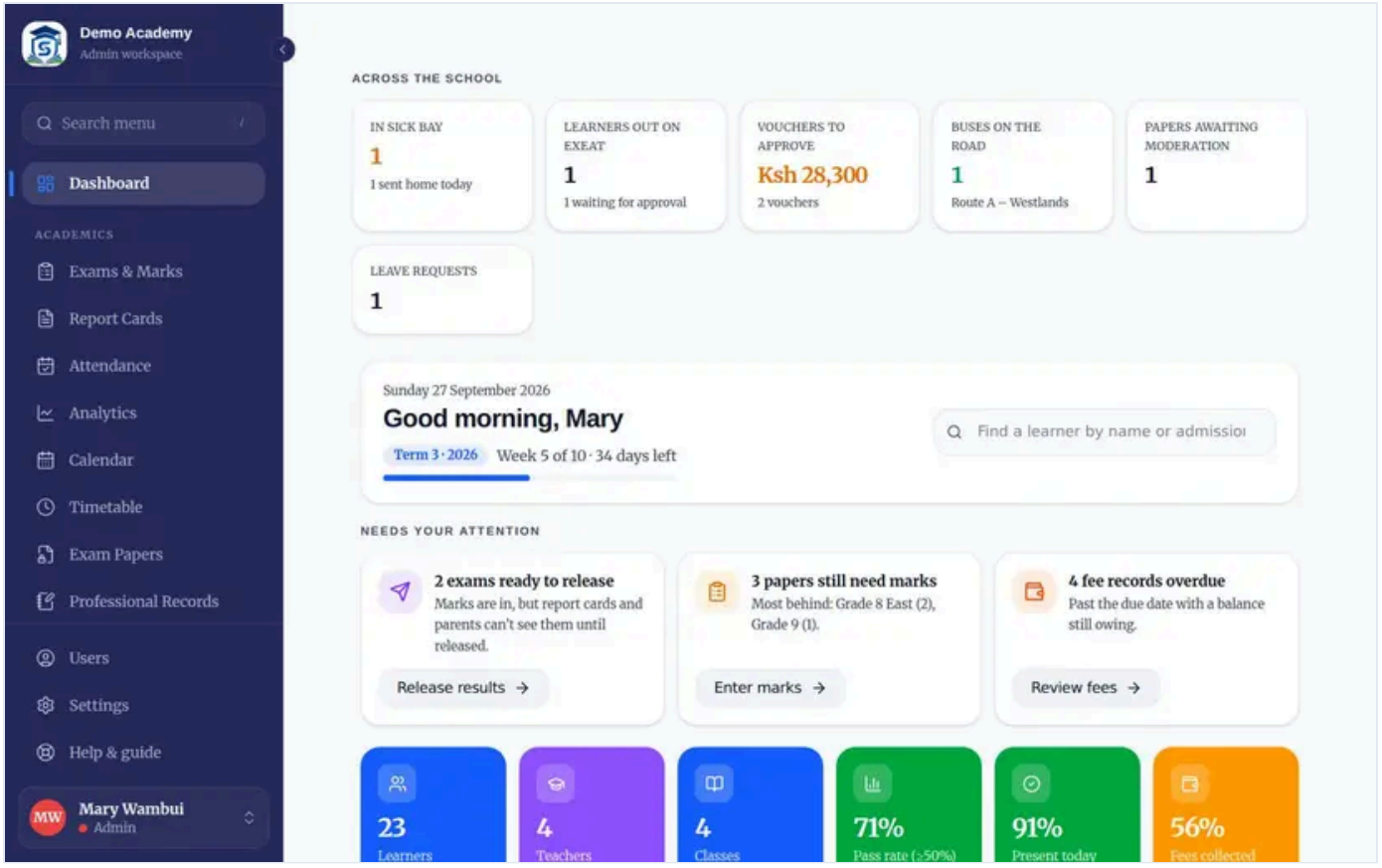
The administrator dashboard.

- The term line shows the current term, the week you are in, how many days are left, and a progress bar. During holidays it shows when the next term opens.
- “Needs your attention” lists what only the school can move forward: exams ready to release, papers still missing marks, subjects with no grading scale, learners not on today’s register, and overdue fees. Each item has a button that takes you straight there. When there is nothing, it says “All caught up”.
- The coloured figures are learners, teachers, classes, pass rate, present today and fees collected. Tap any figure to open its page.
- Quick actions give every common task the same weight: enter marks, report cards, attendance, add a learner or staff member, post an announcement, set an assignment, record a payment.

- Further down: each class's latest results, how classes compare, exams coming up in the next three weeks, attendance and fee summaries, and recent activity.
- The search box finds a learner by name or admission number.

2.2 Across the school

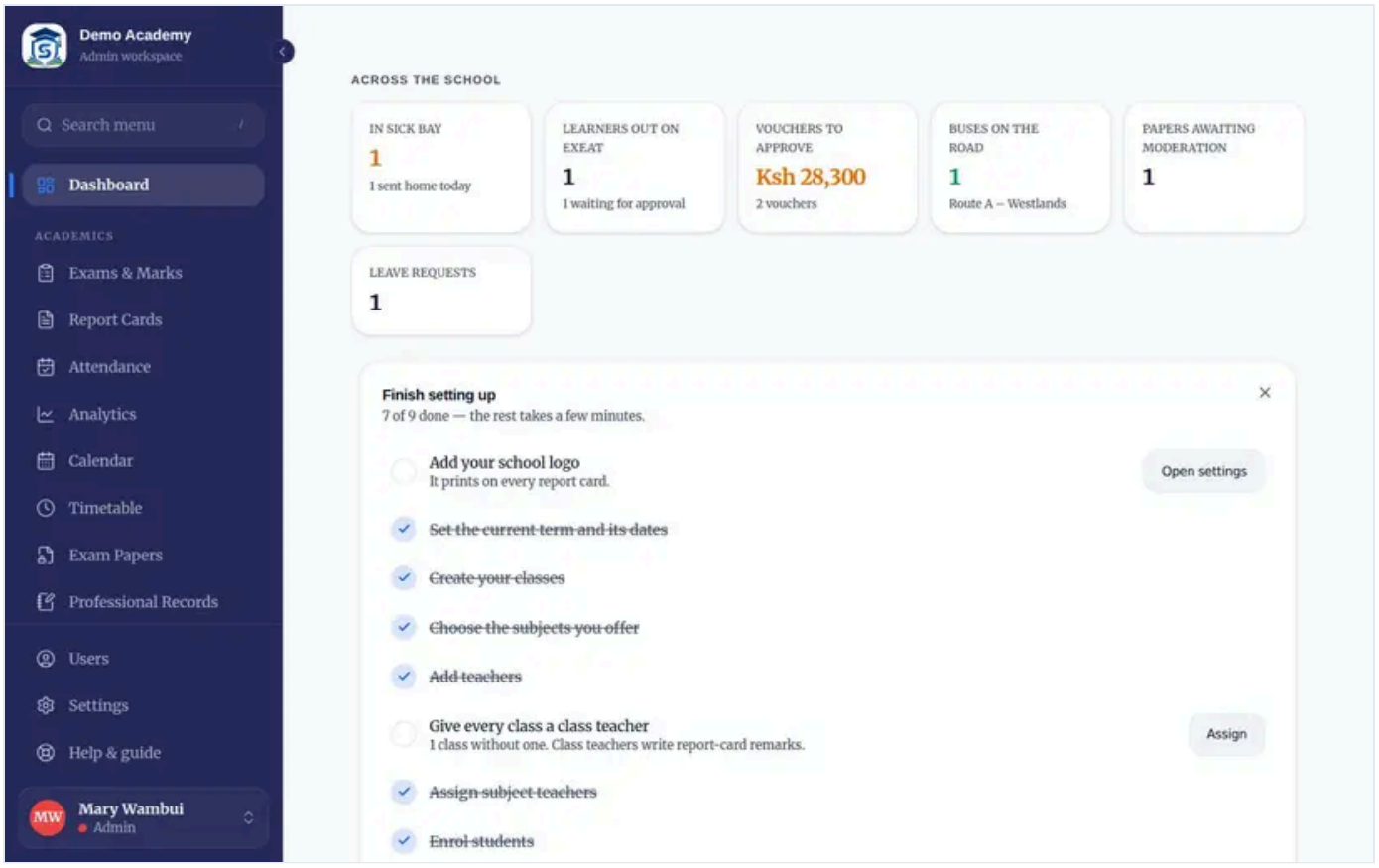
When your school runs modules such as boarding, health, expenses or transport, live figures from each appear at the very top of the dashboard: learners in the sick bay, learners out on exeat, vouchers to approve, buses on the road, papers awaiting moderation and leave requests. Tap a tile to open its page.



"Across the school" tiles above the dashboard.

2.3 The setup checklist

Until the school is fully set up, a checklist sits at the top of the dashboard. Work through it from top to bottom; each item has a button that opens the right page.



The setup checklist. Ticked items are done.

- Add your school logo; set the current term and its dates; create your classes; choose the subjects you offer; add teachers; give every class a class teacher; assign subject teachers; enrol students; add support staff.
- Close the checklist with the × once you no longer need it.

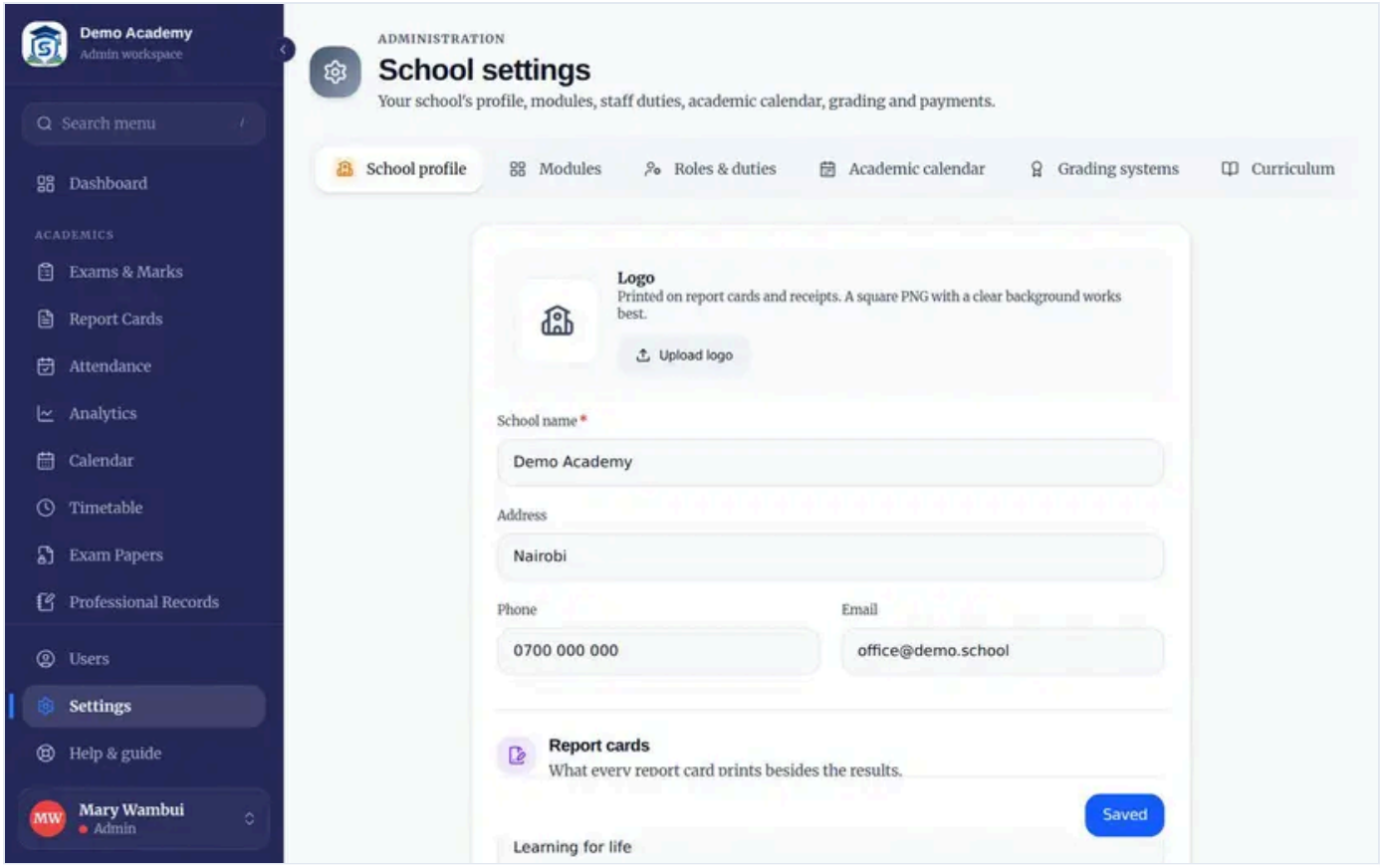
CHAPTER 3

Setting up the school

Do these once at the start, and revisit them at the start of each year. The order matters: classes need grades, subjects need classes, and learners need classes.

3.1 School profile and report card details

Settings → School profile holds everything a report card prints about the school.



Settings → School profile.

1. **Logo**
   Upload a square PNG with a clear background. It prints on report cards and receipts.

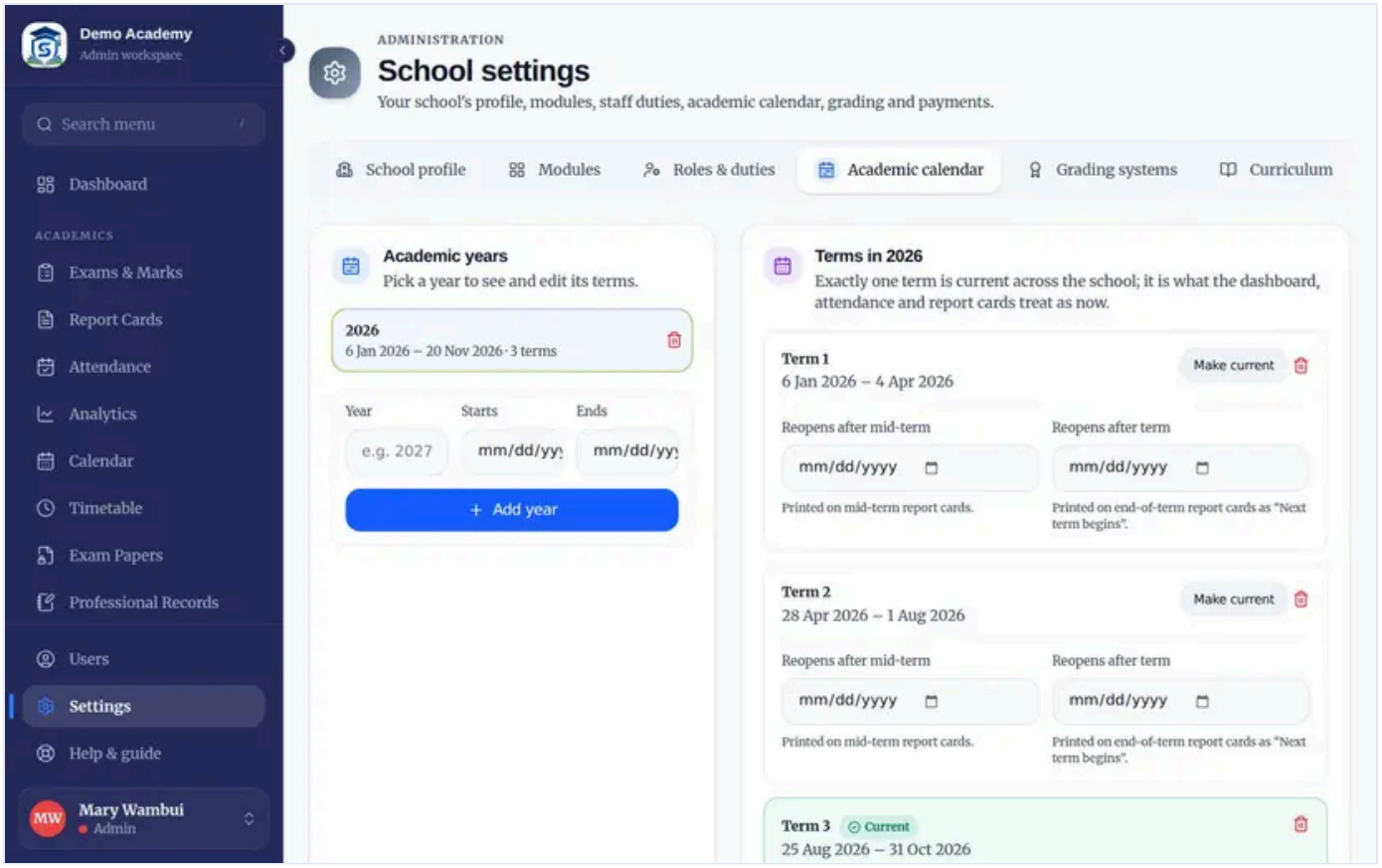
2. **Name and contacts**
   Check the school name, address, phone and email.

3. **Report cards**
   Add the school motto (printed under the name), the principal's name and signature (printed on the signature line), and the pass mark. The pass mark (for example 50%) decides what counts as a pass everywhere in Skulbase: dashboards, analytics and learners' results.

4. **Positions**
   Choose whether CBC report cards show positions, and how Senior School (Grades 10–12) learners are ranked and grouped by subject combination.

3.2 Academic calendar

Settings → Academic calendar holds your years and terms. Exactly one term is current: it is what the dashboard, attendance and report cards treat as “now”.



Settings → Academic calendar.

1. **Add the year**
   Press “Add year” and enter the year, for example 2027.

2. **Add its terms**
   Add each term with its name, start and end dates. Optionally add the mid-term reopening date (printed on mid-term report cards) and the date school reopens after the term (printed as “Next term begins”).

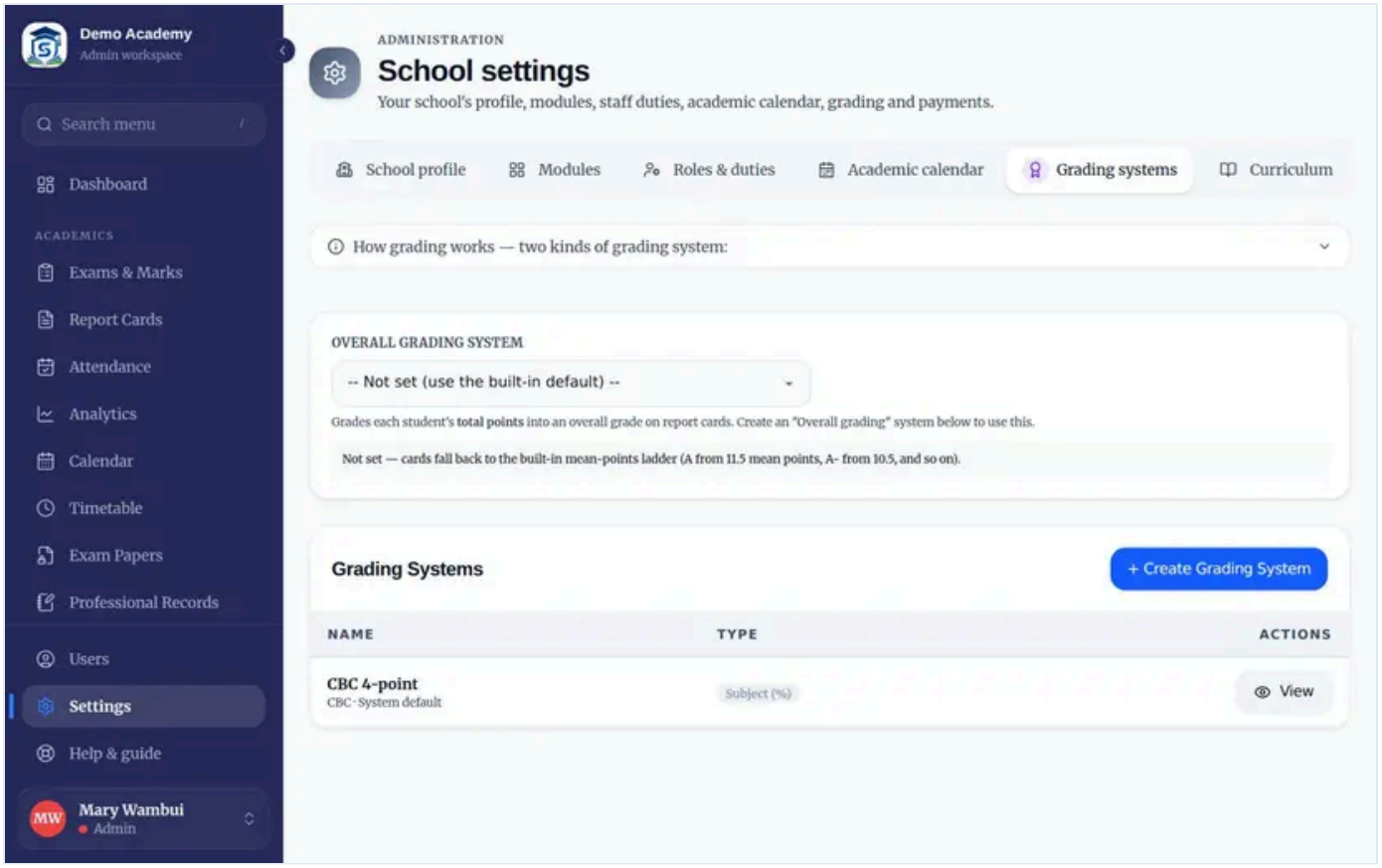
3. **Make a term current**
   Press “Make current” on the term you are in. Do this at the start of every term.

4. **Correct a year or term**
   Press the pencil on a year or a term to change its name or its start and end dates, then “Save changes”. Its exams, marks, report cards and fees stay with it. A term or year can be deleted only while nothing is recorded in it.

⚠ **Good to know:** If no term is current, reports and attendance cannot tell which term it is. The dashboard reminds you.

3.3 Grading systems

Settings → Grading systems decides the grade printed for each mark. There are two kinds: subject grading (the grade for each subject's score) and overall grading (the grade for a learner's overall mean).



Settings → Grading systems.

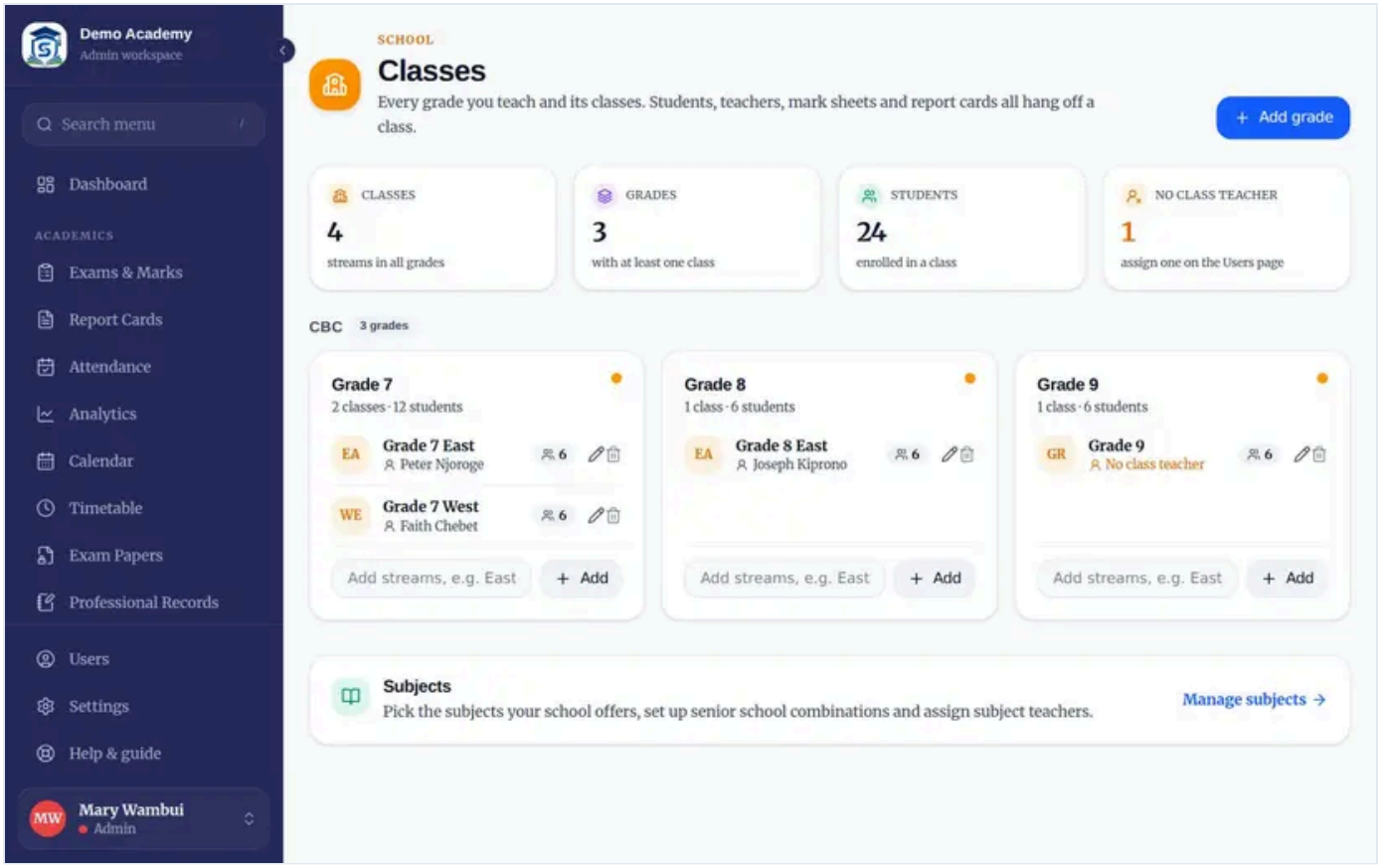
1. **Add a subject grading system**
   Choose the curriculum level, give it a name, and list each grade with its score range, points and remark. CBC schools typically use EE, ME, AE and BE; 8-4-4 schools use A to E.

2. **Choose its subjects**
   Pick which subjects use this system. A subject with no grading system prints no grade, and the dashboard lists it under "Needs your attention".

3. **Add an overall grading system (8-4-4)**
   This grades each learner's mean points on report cards and mark sheets.

3.4 Classes

The Classes page lists every grade you teach and its classes (streams), for example Grade 7 East and Grade 7 West. Learners, teachers, mark sheets and report cards all belong to a class.

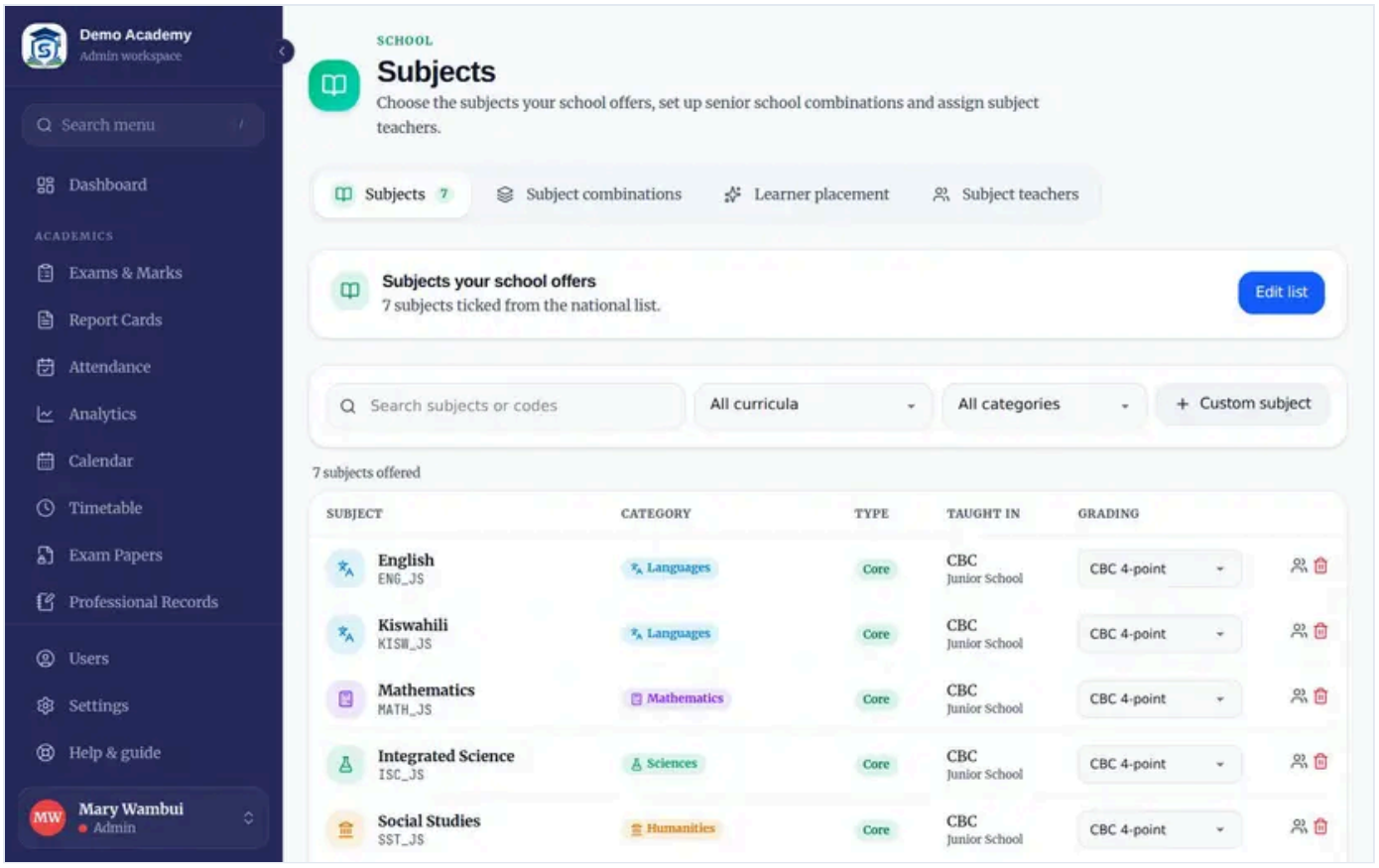


Classes: each grade and its streams, with its class teacher and number of learners.

1. **Add a grade**
   Press “Add grade” and choose it from your curriculum.
2. **Add its classes**
   Add each stream. A grade with a single class still needs one class.
3. **Check class teachers**
   Each class shows its class teacher, or “No class teacher”. Class teachers are assigned when you add or edit a teacher on the Users page.

3.5 Subjects and subject teachers

The Subjects page has three tabs: the subjects your school offers, Senior School subject combinations, and which teacher teaches which subject in which class.



Subjects: tick the subjects you offer.

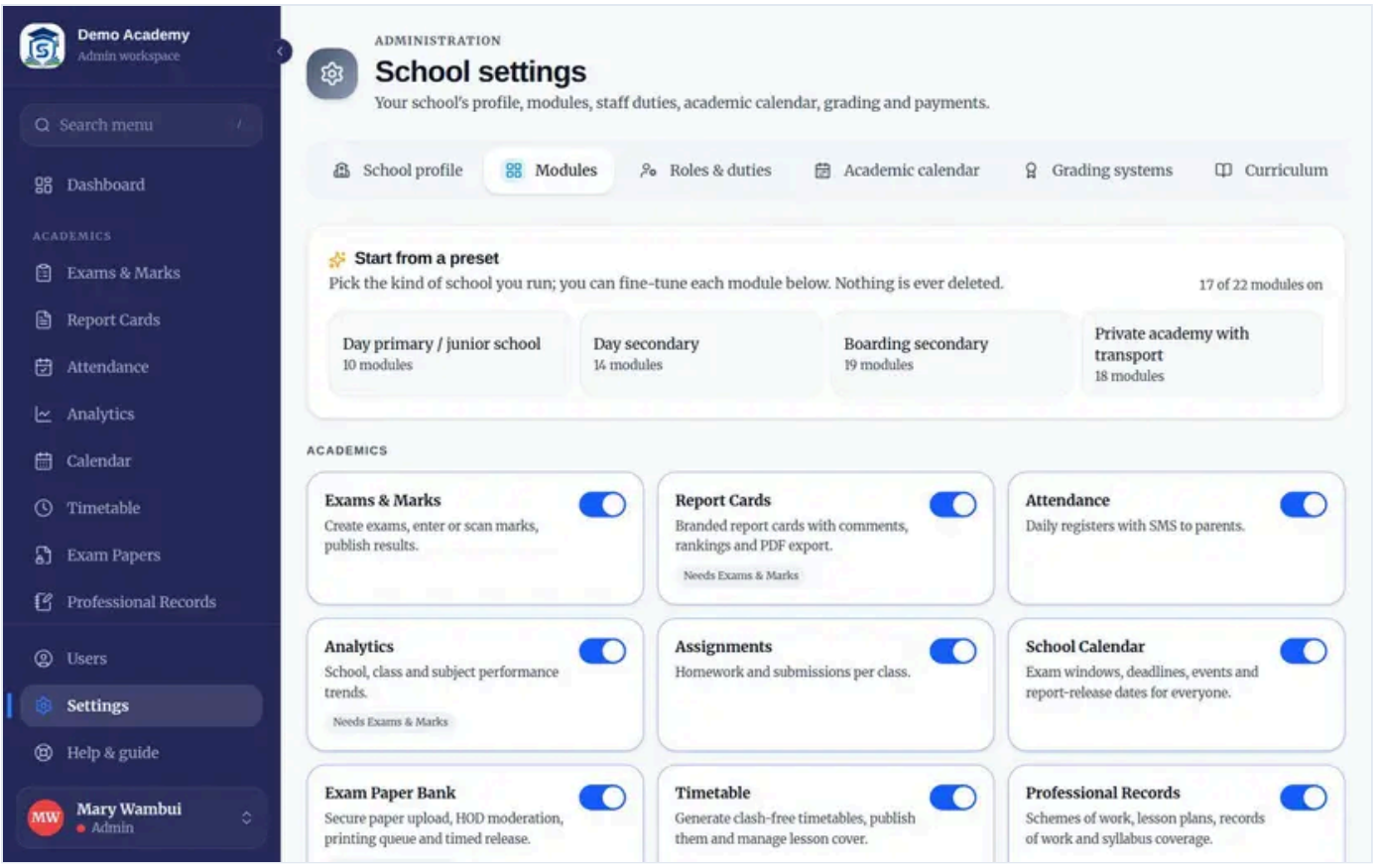
1. **Choose the subjects you offer**
   On the Subjects tab, tick each subject your school teaches for each level.

2. **Senior School combinations (CBC Grades 10–12)**
   On the Subject combinations tab, create the combinations learners can take.

3. **Assign subject teachers**
   On the Subject teachers tab, give each subject in each class its teacher. A teacher only sees the classes and subjects they are assigned to when entering marks.

3.6 Choose what your school runs (modules)

Settings → Modules switches parts of Skulbase on and off for your school. A module that is off disappears from menus and dashboards for everyone; its data is kept, and switching it back on brings everything back.



Settings → Modules: start from a preset, then switch individual modules on or off.

1. **Start from a preset**
   Pick the kind of school you run: day primary or junior school, day secondary, boarding secondary, or private academy with transport. The preset switches on the modules that kind of school usually needs.

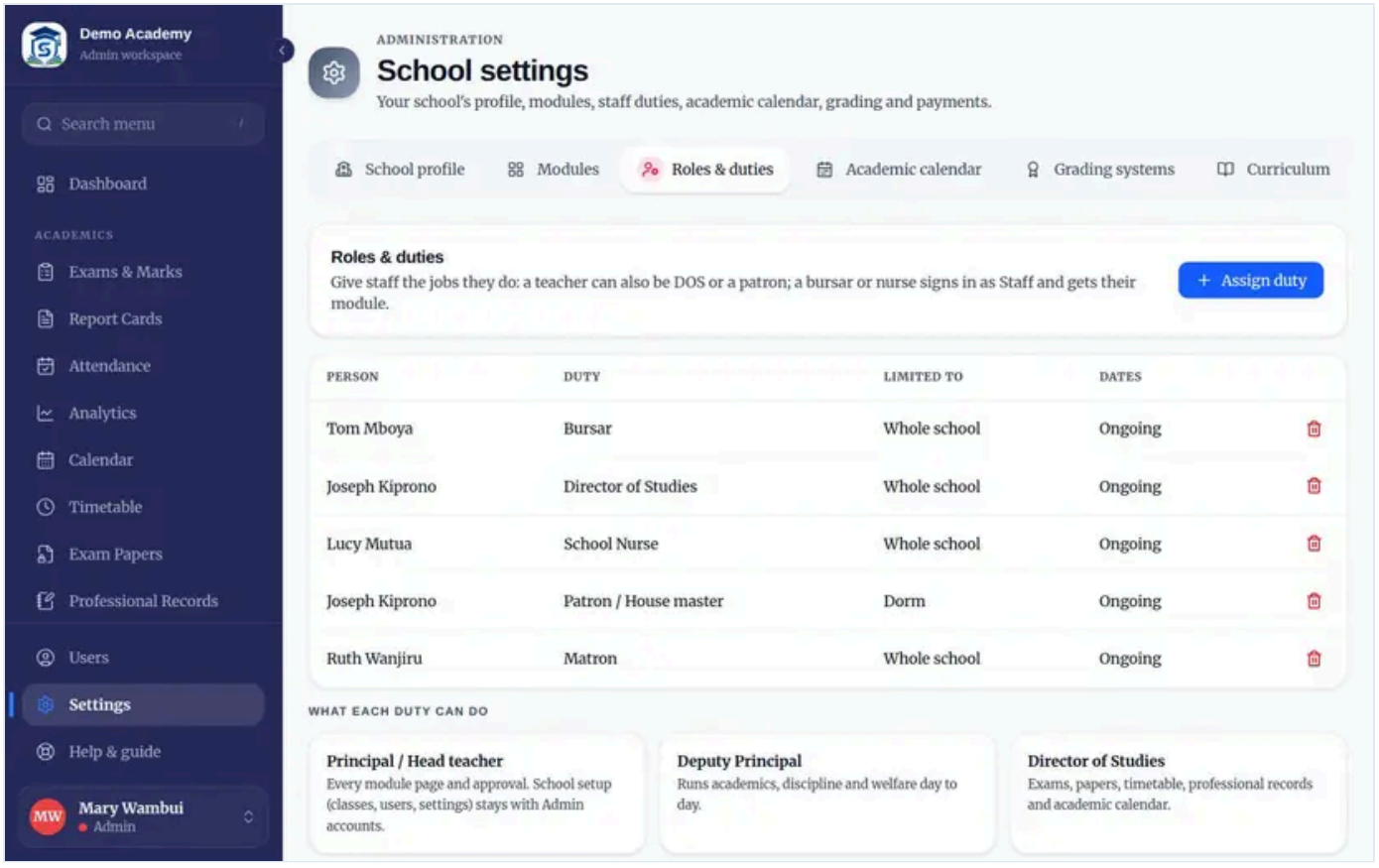
2. **Fine-tune**
   Switch individual modules on or off: academics (exams, report cards, attendance, analytics, assignments, calendar, exam paper bank, timetable, professional records, CBC assessment), finance (fees, billing, expenses), welfare (boarding, health, discipline), operations (transport, live bus tracking, library, inventory) and people (parent portal, staff leave).

3. **Dependencies**
   Some modules need another first (for example report cards need Exams & Marks, and live tracking needs Transport); these are turned on together, and turning one off turns off what depends on it.

> **Tip:** A module marked “Not included in your plan” needs to be enabled by Skulbase first.

3.7 Give staff their duties

Settings → Roles & duties gives people the jobs they hold on top of their account type: a teacher can also be the DOS and a house patron; a bursar, nurse or driver signs in as Staff and gets their pages from their duty.



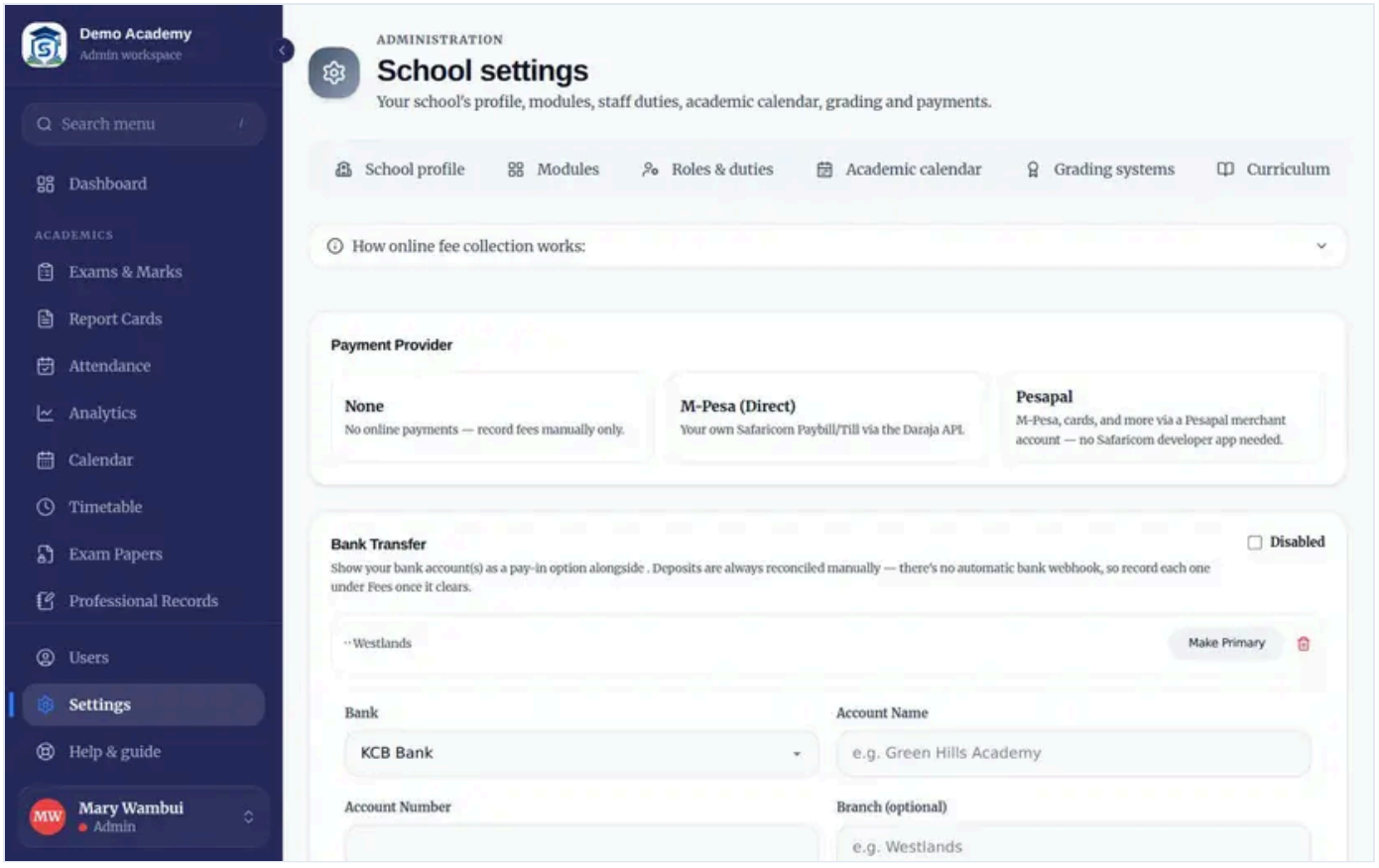
Settings → Roles & duties, with “What each duty can do” below.

1. **Assign a duty**
   Press “Assign duty”, choose the person and the duty: Principal, Deputy Principal, DOS, HOD, Timetabler, Exams Officer, Bursar, Accountant, Matron, Patron, School Nurse, Discipline Master, Transport Manager, Driver, Librarian, Storekeeper or HR / Secretary.
2. **Limit it (optional)**
   Some duties can be limited to one class, dorm or route (for example a patron to their own dorm). Leave it empty for the whole school.
3. **Set dates (optional)**
   Give a start and end date for a duty that only lasts a term, such as a duty roster.

- “What each duty can do” lists exactly what every duty unlocks.
- The person sees their new pages the next time they open Skulbase. Each duty has its own guide under Help & guide.
- Duties only show pages for modules the school has switched on.

3.8 Online fee payments (optional)

Settings → Payments lets learners and parents pay fees from the learner's Fees page. Payments are matched to the right learner automatically.



Settings → Payments.

- Choose one automated provider: M-Pesa (direct, with your Paybill or Till number and Daraja keys) or Pesapal. Learners then see a single Pay button.
- Add your bank accounts to show bank transfer details on the learner's Fees page.
- Payments that could not be matched to a learner (for example a wrong account number) appear under "Unmatched payments" for you to assign.

⚠ **Good to know:** Test with the sandbox environment first, then switch to production (live) once a test payment works.

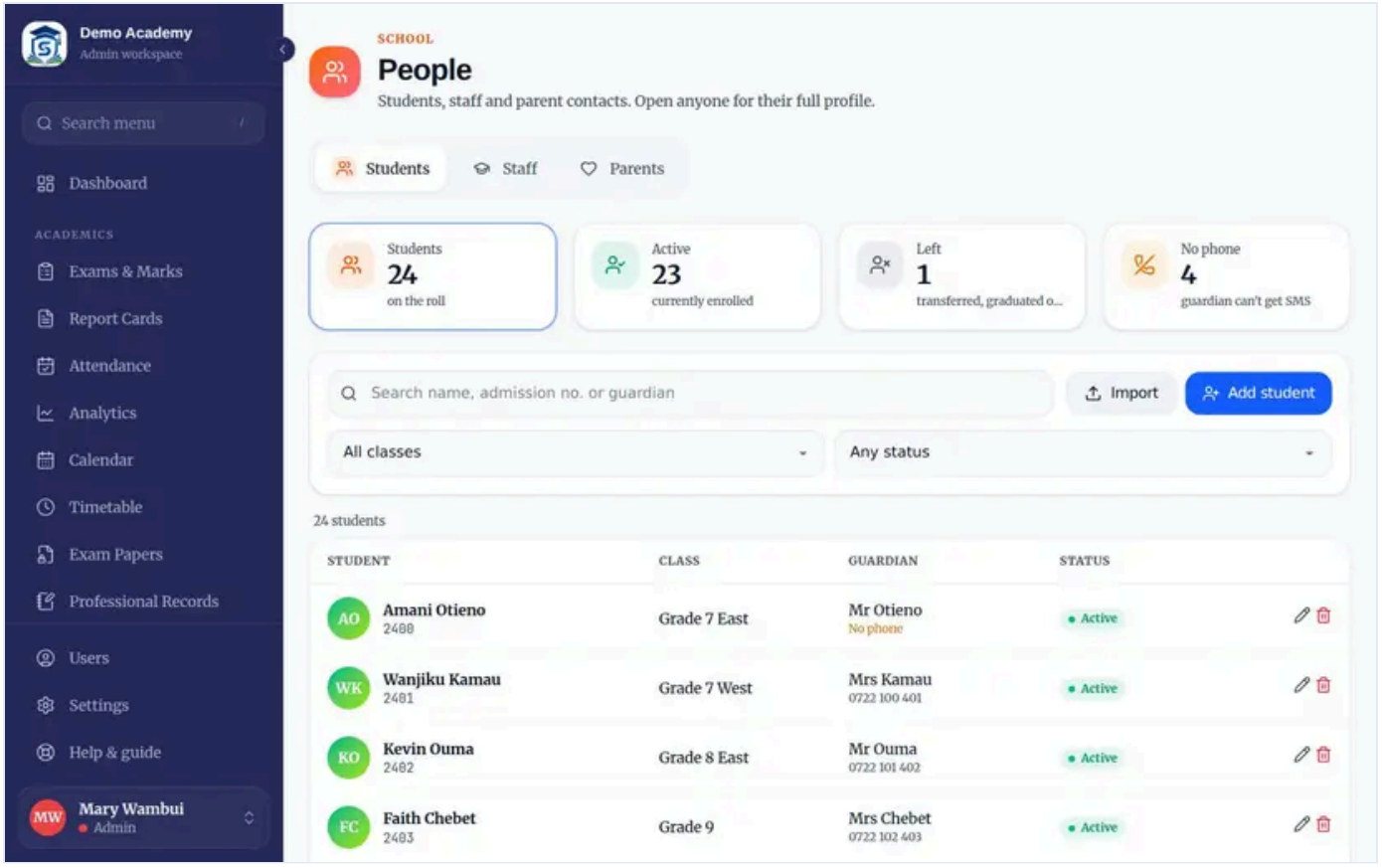
CHAPTER 4

People and accounts

Everyone at the school has a record on the People page. Staff and learners who need to sign in also get an account, created on the Users page or when you add them, with an invite code to activate it.

4.1 Add learners

People → Students is the school roll. Add learners one at a time or import a whole class from Excel or CSV.



People → Students: search, filter by class or status, and add or import learners.

1. **Add one learner**
   Press “Add student”. Enter their name, admission number, class, gender and date of birth, and their guardian’s name and phone number (used for SMS).

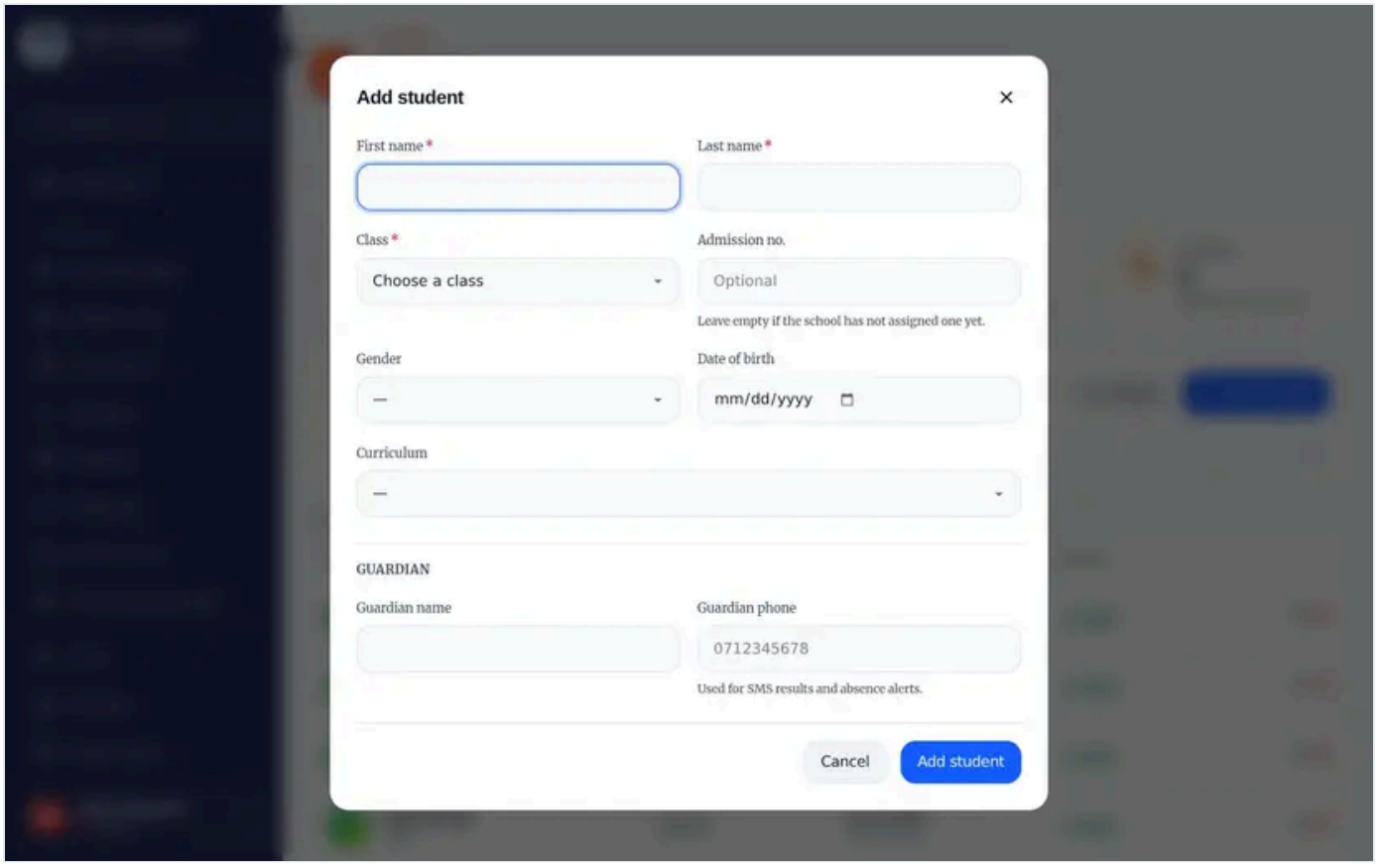
2. **Import a class list**
   Press Import, choose the class everyone in the file joins, and upload your Excel or CSV file. Any rows with problems are listed so you can fix them and import again.

3. **Save the invite codes**
   After adding learners, their invite codes are shown once. Copy them or download the CSV before closing, and give each learner their code.

- Filter by class, status (active, transferred, graduated), pathway or subject combination, or search by name, admission number or guardian.
- “Pathways” sets Senior School pathways for several learners at once.
- Open a learner to see their profile: their details, term-by-term performance, attendance for each term from the daily register, and every term with released results as a report card you can open.

4.2 The Add student form

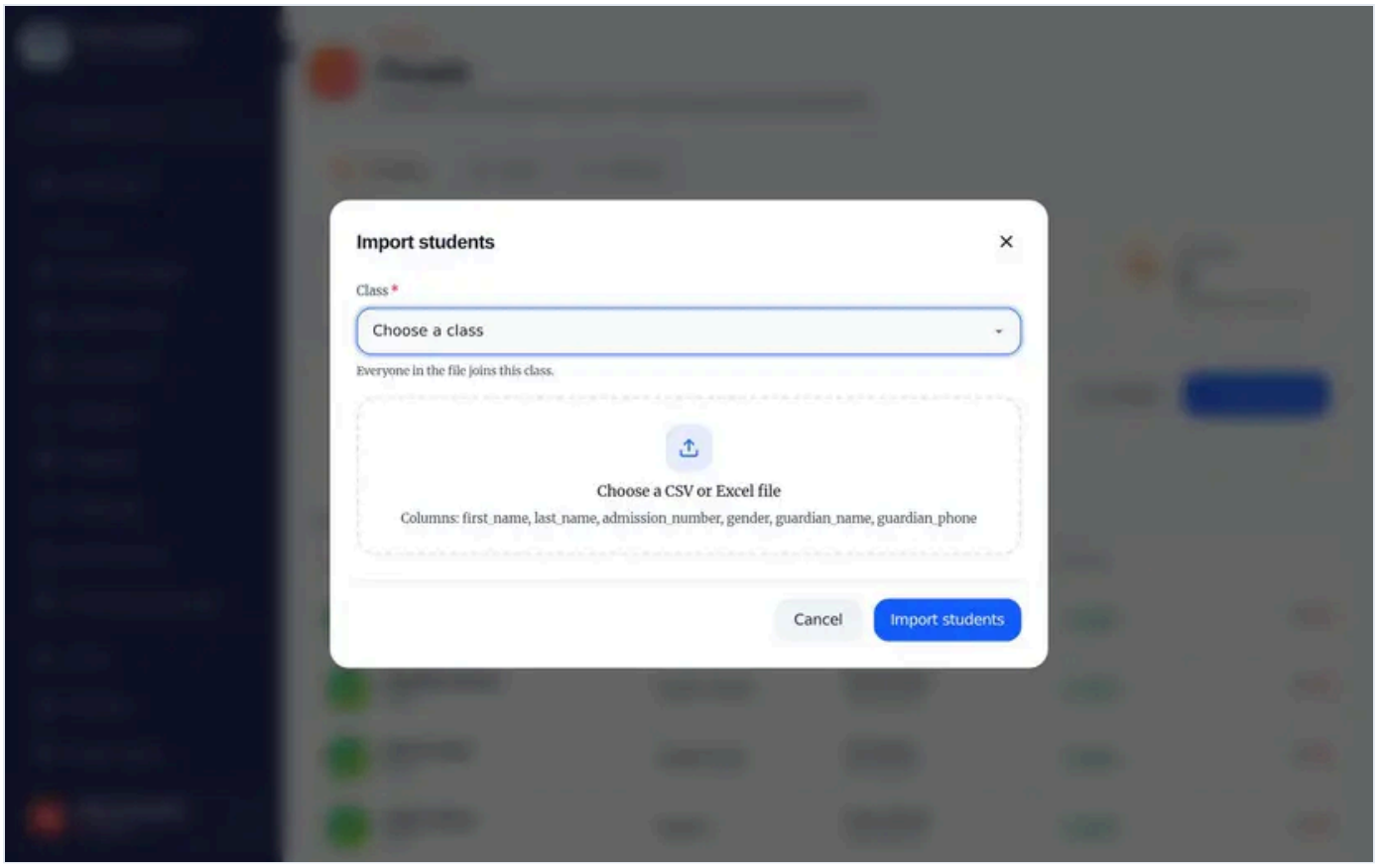
Guardian phone numbers matter: they are where results, absence notices and announcements are texted.



Adding one learner.

4.3 Import learners from a spreadsheet

The fastest way to enrol a class. Every learner in the file joins the class you choose.

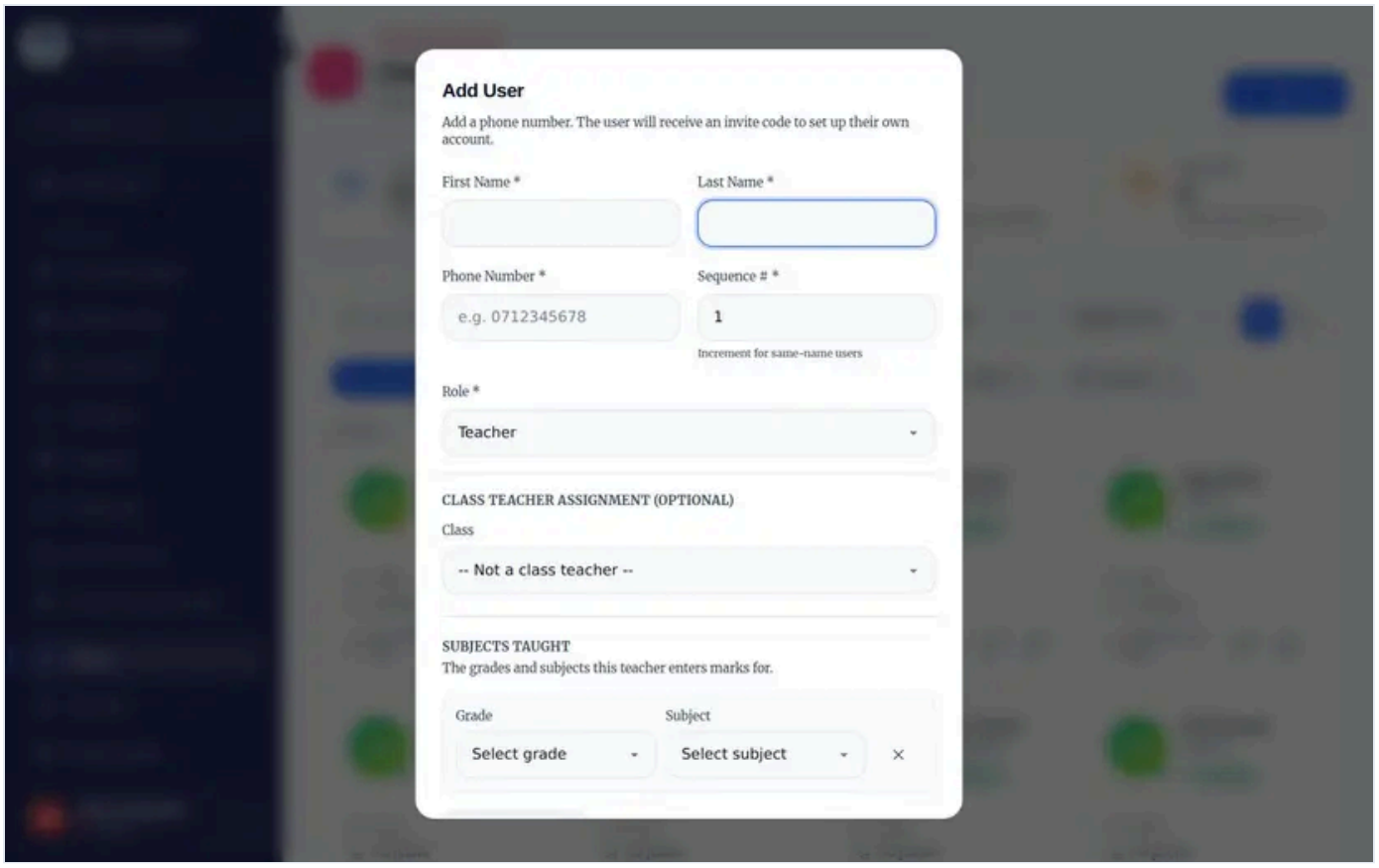


Importing a class list.

> **Tip:** Put one learner per row, with columns for first name, last name, admission number, gender and guardian phone.

4.4 Staff and accounts

The Users page lists everyone with an account. “Add user” creates an account for a teacher, learner, administrator or other staff member and gives you their invite code.



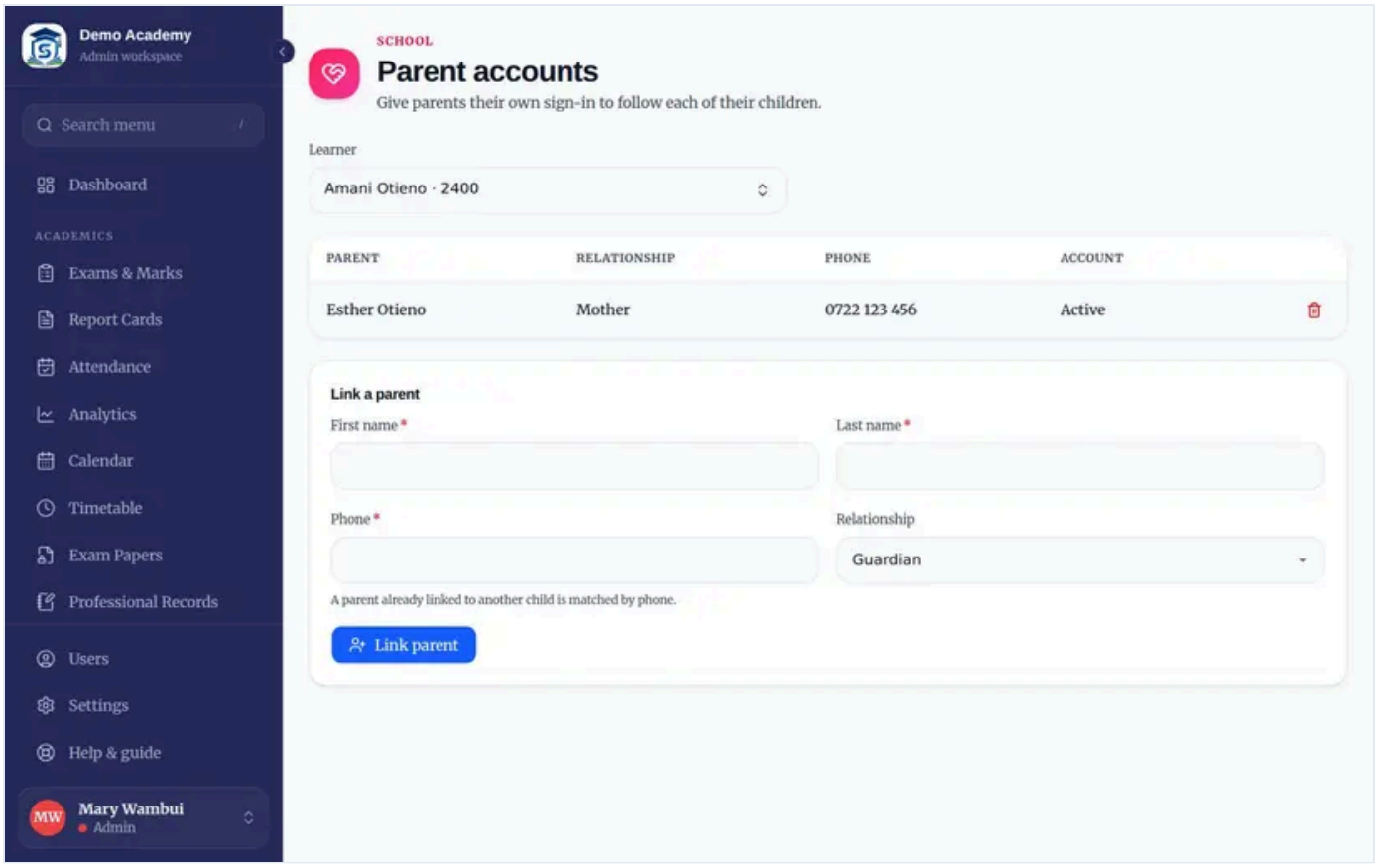
Add user: choose the role. For a teacher, you can also make them a class teacher and list the subjects they teach.

1. **Add the person**
   On Users press “Add user”. Enter their first and last name and phone number. Use the sequence number only when two people have the same name.
2. **Choose the role**
   Teacher, Student, Other Staff (for example a bursar or secretary) or Admin.
3. **For a teacher**
   Optionally choose the class they are class teacher of, and add the grades and subjects they teach.
4. **Share their invite**
   Skulbase shows their username, invite code and an activation link. It tries to send the code by SMS; you can also press “Send on WhatsApp” or copy it.

- Open anyone on the Users page to see their full profile, edit their account, or reset it (which issues a new invite code, for example when someone forgets their password and has no email address).
- “Print activation codes” prints codes for everyone who has not activated yet, for example to hand out to a class.

4.5 Give parents their own login

With the Parent Portal module on, parents sign in to follow each of their children: results, report cards, fees (and paying them), attendance and the school bus. You link a parent to a learner on the Parent accounts page, and the parent activates their account with the invite code they are texted.



Parent accounts: choose a learner, see who is linked, and link another parent.

1. **One learner (Parents tab)**
   Pick the learner. Parents already linked are listed with their relationship, phone and whether their account is active. Under “Link a parent”, enter the parent’s first and last name, phone number and relationship (mother, father, guardian, sponsor), and press “Link parent”.

2. **A whole class (Whole class tab)**
   Pick a class. Every learner not yet linked gets a row, started from the contact on their record. Check or fill in each parent and press “Link N parents”. Each row succeeds or fails on its own and says so; fix any marked row and link again.

3. **From a fee account**
   When a learner’s fee account shows no linked parent, link one there without leaving Fees.

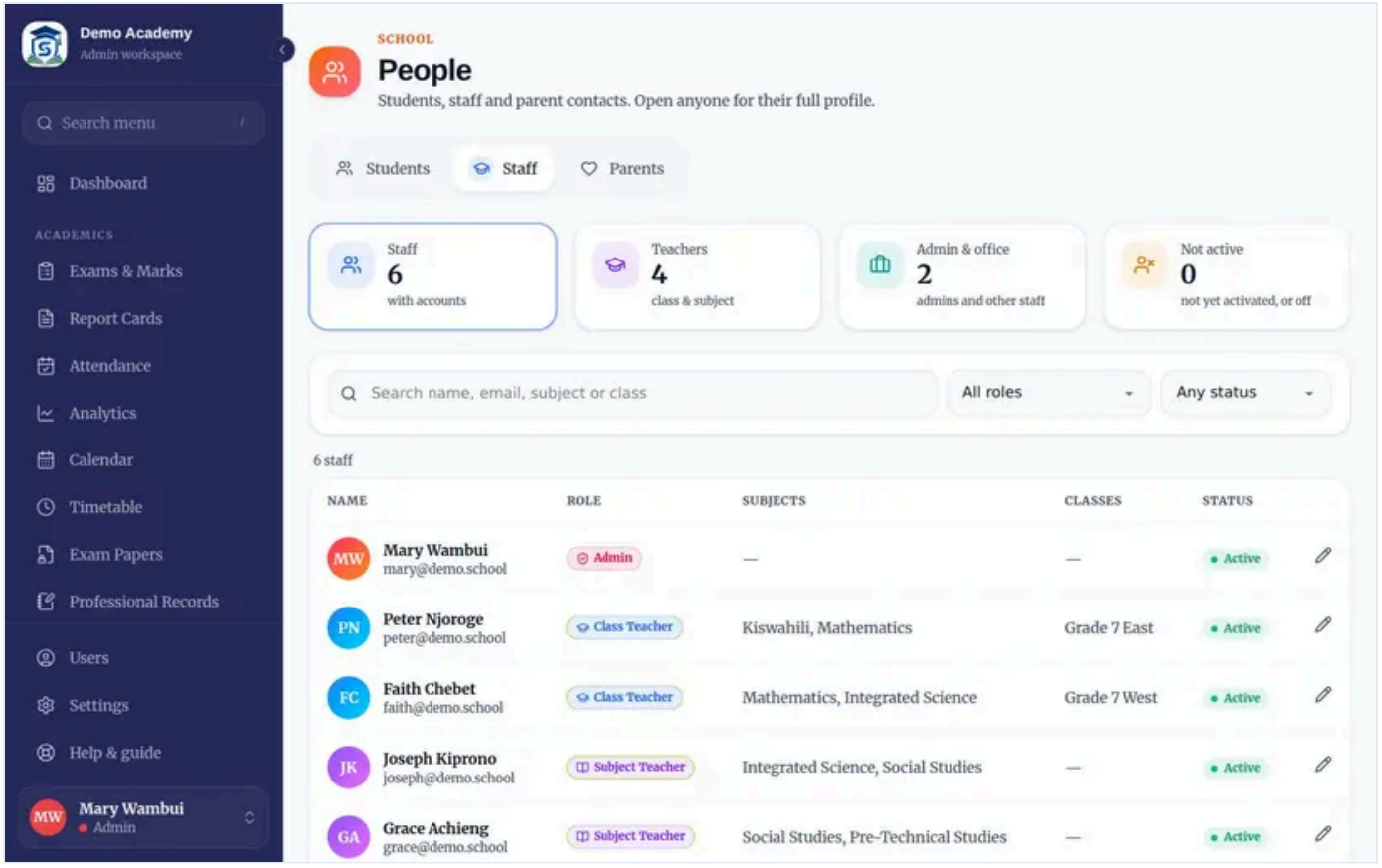
4. **The parent activates**
   A new parent gets an invite code by SMS (Skulbase also shows it). They activate their account with it on the activation page, exactly like a teacher or learner.

- A parent is matched by phone number however it is typed (07..., 254... or +254...), so a parent of three children has one login that shows all of them.

- Linked parents receive absence texts and fee reminders as well as the number on the learner's record.
- Unlinking a parent stops them seeing that child.

4.6 Staff and parents directories

People → Staff lists teachers and other staff with their roles, subjects and classes. People → Parents is built from guardian details on learners' records: one card per guardian with their children, and buttons to call or email.



People → Staff.

CHAPTER 5

Exams and marks

Marks are entered by teachers (and administrators) on Exams & Marks, checked, and then released so learners and parents can see them. As administrator you can do everything a teacher can, for every class and subject. You also choose which exam each class is marking, follow who is behind, and lock a term once its report cards are out.

5.1 Choose the exam being marked

"Exam being marked" on Enter & Correct Marks decides which exam each class is marking. Teachers then go straight to it, so Mid-Term marks never land in End-Term. Administrators, and staff with the Principal, Deputy Principal, DOS or Exams Officer duty, see it.

1. **Pick each level's exam**
   Each level (for example Junior School) has a card. Choose the exam it is sitting, and every class in the level moves to it. A class sitting something different, such as a Form 4 mock, can be set on its own.
2. **Set the exam dates**
   Under a level's "Exam dates", pick the day each exam starts. Every paper of that exam for the level's classes moves to that date, so Skulbase knows which exam is due.
3. **Move on when it changes**
   Once an exam is over, the card offers "Mid-Term done? Move on to End-Term". Earlier exams stay open for corrections. "Stop marking" closes a level's exam.
4. **Answer requests**
   When a teacher presses "Ask for the exam", their class shows "Asked by" with their name until you choose one.

- The heading says how many classes still have no exam chosen. Teachers there pick an exam themselves until you choose one.
- CATs and topical tests are always open; teachers reach them from "Mark a CAT, correct an earlier exam or open another term".

5.2 See who is behind on marking

"Marking progress" on Enter & Correct Marks lists, for the exam each class is marking, every subject in every stream as marks entered out of expected, with the teacher assigned. Unfinished sheets come first, so you can nudge the right teacher before report-card day. Tap a cell to open that mark sheet.

5.3 Enter or correct marks

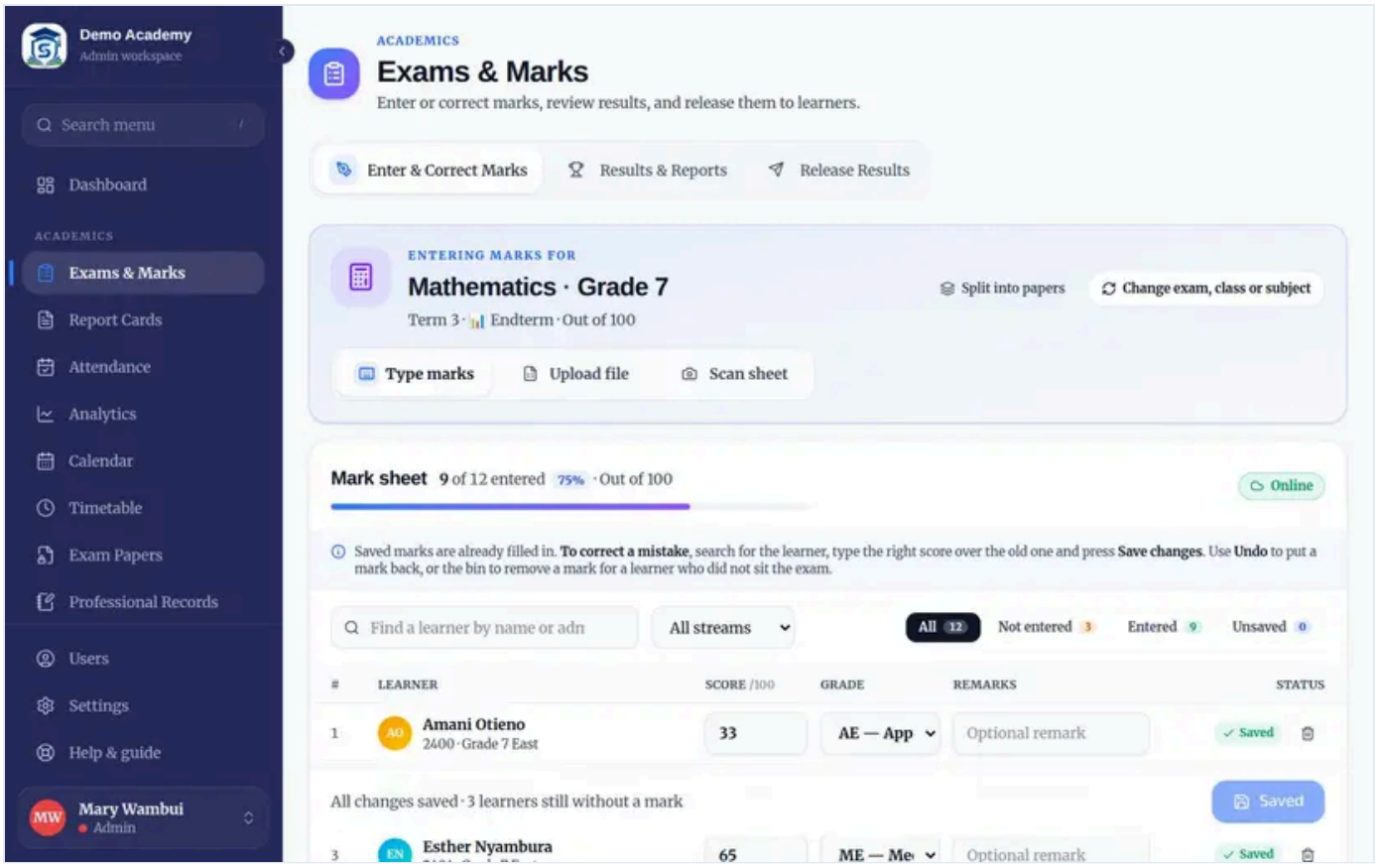
Marks go in on Exams & Marks, on the “Enter & Correct Marks” tab. The school chooses which exam each class is marking, so you only pick the class and subject: the mark sheet opens on the right exam and your marks cannot land in the wrong one.

1. **Open Exams & Marks**
   Choose Exams & Marks in the menu. The “Enter & Correct Marks” tab is open.
2. **Pick up where you left off**
   If you were part-way through a sheet, “Pick up where you left off” at the top opens it again.
3. **Choose the class and subject**
   “Marking now” lists each of your classes with the exam it is on (for example End-Term) and your subjects there. Pick the class, then the subject. You only see the classes and subjects you teach.
4. **Open the mark sheet**
   The sheet opens on the exam your school is marking, with a badge naming it. Saved marks are already filled in.

- No exam open for a class yet? It shows “No exam open yet”. Press “Ask for the exam”: your administrator, principal or DOS sees the request and opens the right one.
- To mark a CAT, correct an earlier exam or work in another term, press “Mark a CAT, correct an earlier exam or open another term” and choose the term, exam, class and subject yourself. A sheet also lists “Other exams for this class” to jump between them.
- If you open an empty sheet for an exam the school is not marking, Skulbase asks you to check which exam the marks are from before you start.

5.4 Using the mark sheet

The mark sheet lists every learner with a box for their score. The grade fills itself in from your school’s grading system.



The mark sheet: type a score, press Enter to move to the next learner, then Save changes.

1. **Type the scores**
   Click the first score box, type the mark and press Enter to jump to the next learner. The grade appears as you type. Remarks are optional.

2. **Save**
   Press “Save changes” at the bottom. The bar tells you how many learners still have no mark.

3. **Correct a mistake**
   Find the learner with the search box, type the right score over the old one, and save. Undo puts a mark back as it was; the bin removes a mark for a learner who did not sit the exam.

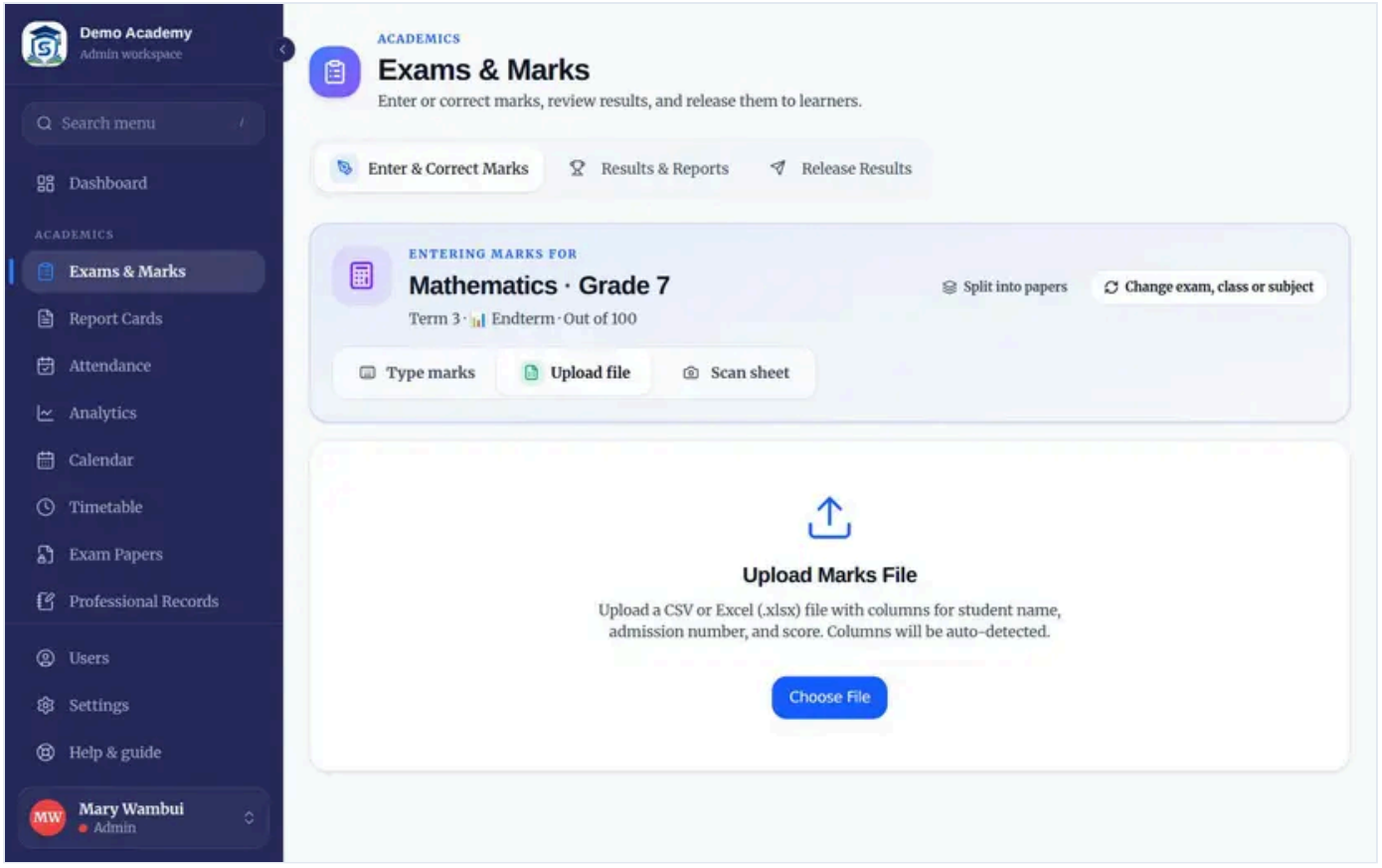
4. **Filter the list**
   Use the tabs (All, Not entered, Entered, Unsaved) and the stream filter to find who is left.

- “Online” at the top right shows the sheet is connected. If the network drops, your typing is kept on this device and saved when you are back online.
- Scores are out of the exam’s maximum (shown at the top, for example “Out of 100”).
- A subject with several papers can be split with “Split into papers”; each paper then gets its own column and the final mark is worked out for you.
- Once every learner on the sheet has a saved mark, the sheet offers to release the results there and then, so learners and parents can see them. You can still correct a mark afterwards.

- “Change history” at the bottom lists every mark entered, changed or removed on the sheet: the old and new score, who saved it and when. The search box narrows it to one learner.
- When the school locks a finished term, its sheets say so and cannot be saved. Ask whoever runs exams to unlock it for a correction.

5.5 Upload marks from a spreadsheet or a photo

Instead of typing, you can upload an Excel or CSV file, or take a photo of a handwritten mark sheet.



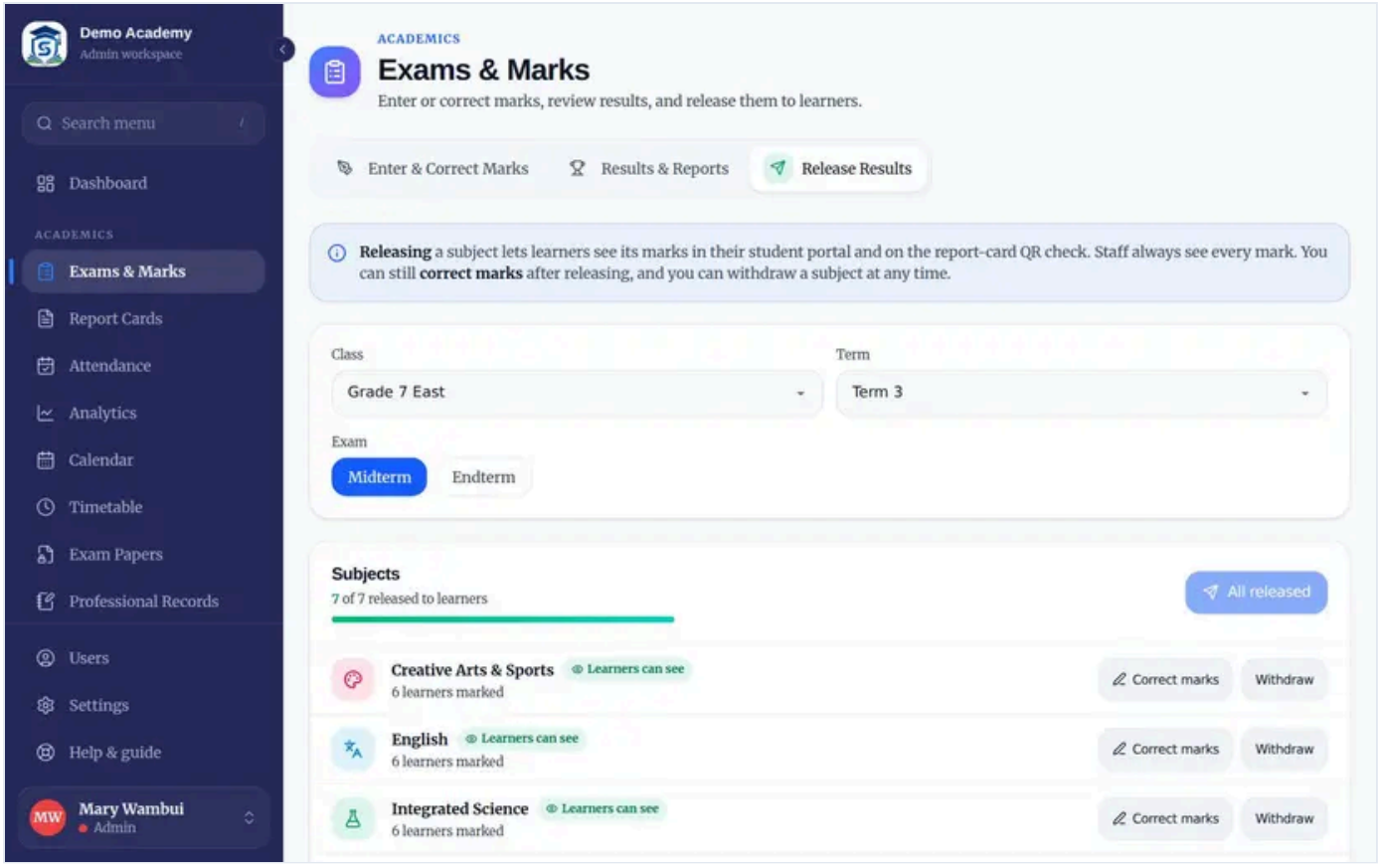
“Upload file” reads marks from Excel or CSV; “Scan sheet” reads a photo of a paper mark sheet.

1. **Upload a file**
   On the mark sheet choose “Upload file”, pick your Excel or CSV file, and check the columns Skulbase detected (learner, admission number, score). Press “Validate & Preview”, check the rows, then save.
2. **Scan a paper sheet**
   Choose “Scan sheet” and take or upload a clear photo. Skulbase reads the names and scores; check every row, fix anything misread, and confirm. Nothing is saved until you confirm.

> **Tip:** Admission numbers are the most reliable way to match rows to learners. Keep them in your spreadsheet.

5.6 Release results to learners

Marks stay private to staff until they are released. Releasing a subject lets learners see its marks in their portal and on the report card's QR check.



Release Results: each subject shows how many learners are marked and whether learners can see it.

1. **Open the Release Results tab**
   On Exams & Marks choose "Release Results". "Ready to release" at the top lists every paper this term that has its marks in and is not yet released, grouped by class and exam, each group one click from released.

2. **Choose the class, term and exam**
   The list shows every subject for that exam and how many learners have marks.

3. **Check the ranking preview**
   Scroll down to see the class ranking the release would produce, and any learners with missing papers (a missing paper counts as 0).

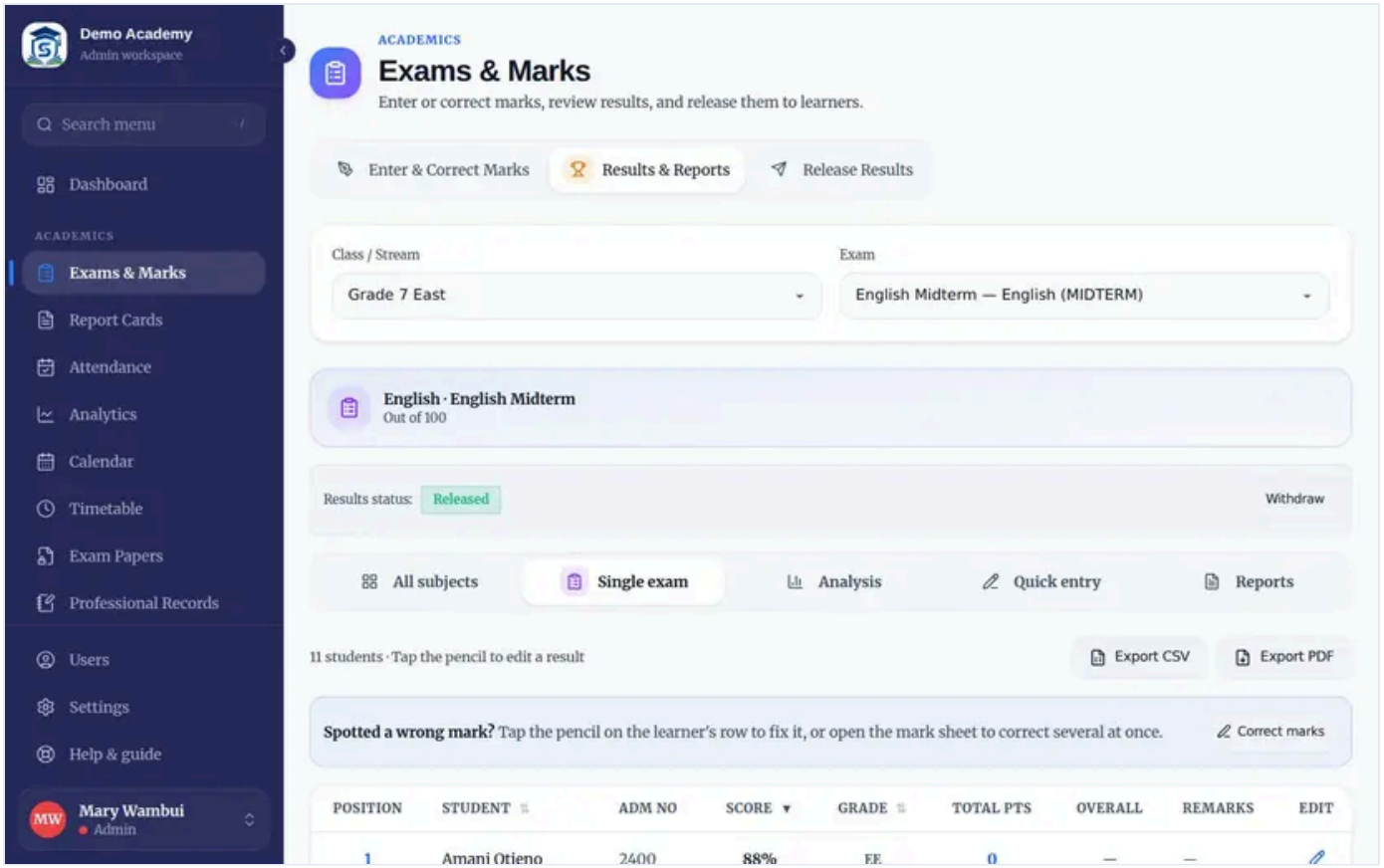
4 Release

Release a single subject, or all of them at once. Released subjects show “Learners can see”.

- You can still correct marks after releasing; learners see the corrected mark.
- A finished mark sheet also offers to release its subject on the spot.
- “Withdraw” hides a subject from learners again at any time.

5.7 See a class’s results

The “Results & Reports” tab on Exams & Marks shows how a class did: every subject side by side, one exam at a time, the analysis, and individual report cards.



Results & Reports: choose a class, then an exam, to see its results.

- Choose a class. “All subjects” is the broadsheet and rankings, with its own term and exam choice.
- For one subject, choose the term (the current one is selected), the exam and the subject. It opens on the exam the school is marking for that class, and each subject shows whether it is released.
- “Correct marks” opens that paper’s mark sheet on Enter & Correct Marks.
- Click a learner to download their PDF report card. Whole-class report cards are on the Report Cards page.

5.8 Lock a finished term

Once report cards are out, lock the term so nobody changes a mark by mistake. The lock card is on Enter & Correct Marks for those who choose the exam being marked.

1. **Lock it**
   Press “Lock term” on the card and confirm. Nobody can enter, change or remove a mark in that term until it is unlocked. Releasing results still works.
2. **Unlock for a correction**
   Press Unlock, let the teacher fix the mark, then lock the term again.

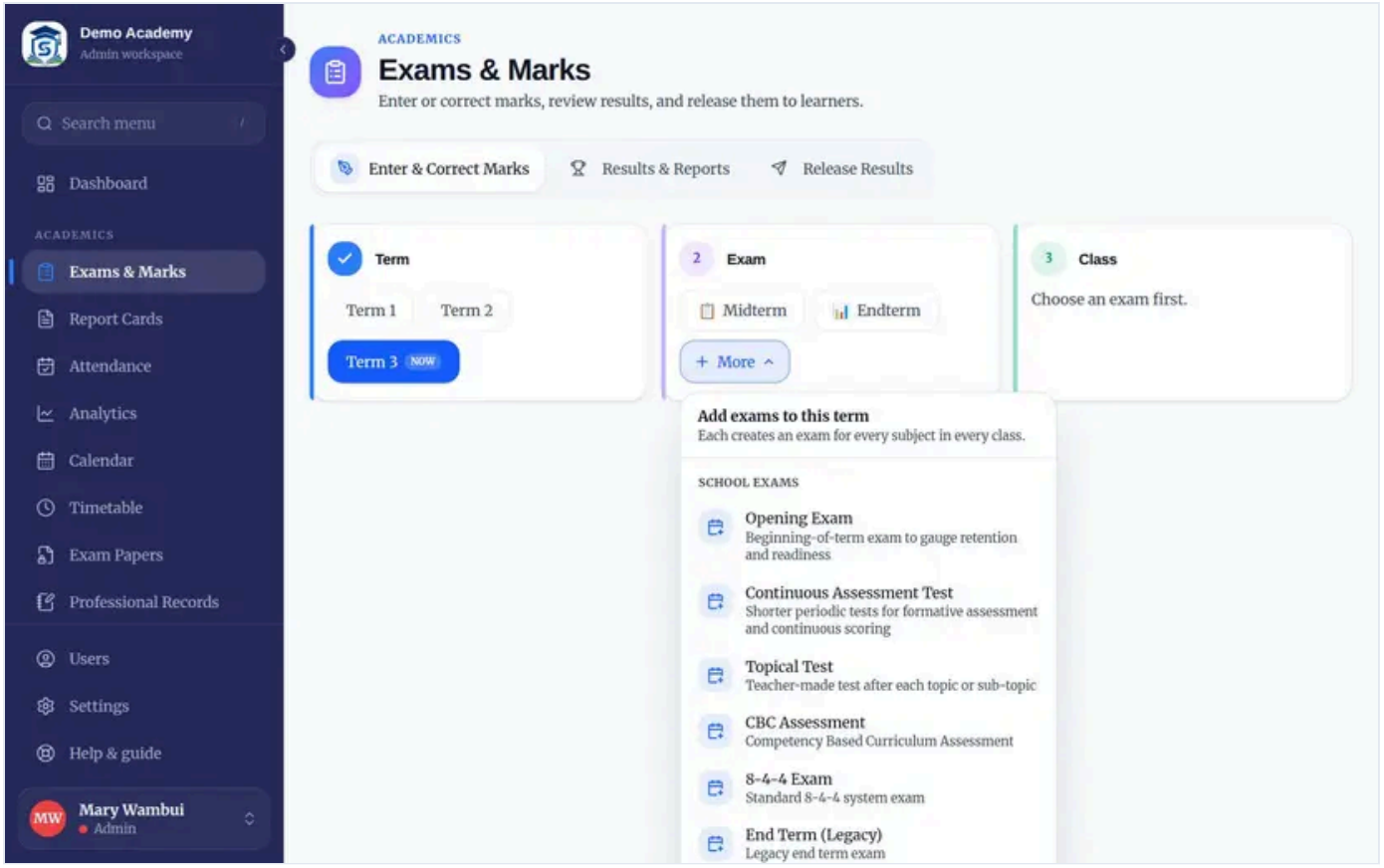
CHAPTER 6

Setting up exams

Each term's exams are created once, and every subject in every class gets its own exam to enter marks against.

6.1 Add exams to the term

On Exams & Marks, the "More" button next to the exams opens the exam menu.



Add exams to this term: each one creates an exam for every subject in every class.

- School exams: Opener, CAT, Midterm, Endterm and others. Pick one to create it for every subject in every class for the term.
- External and mock exams: zone, sub-county, county and national exams and mocks.
- Tools: fill in the term's exams for subjects added since they were set up, or create a single exam for one subject and class.

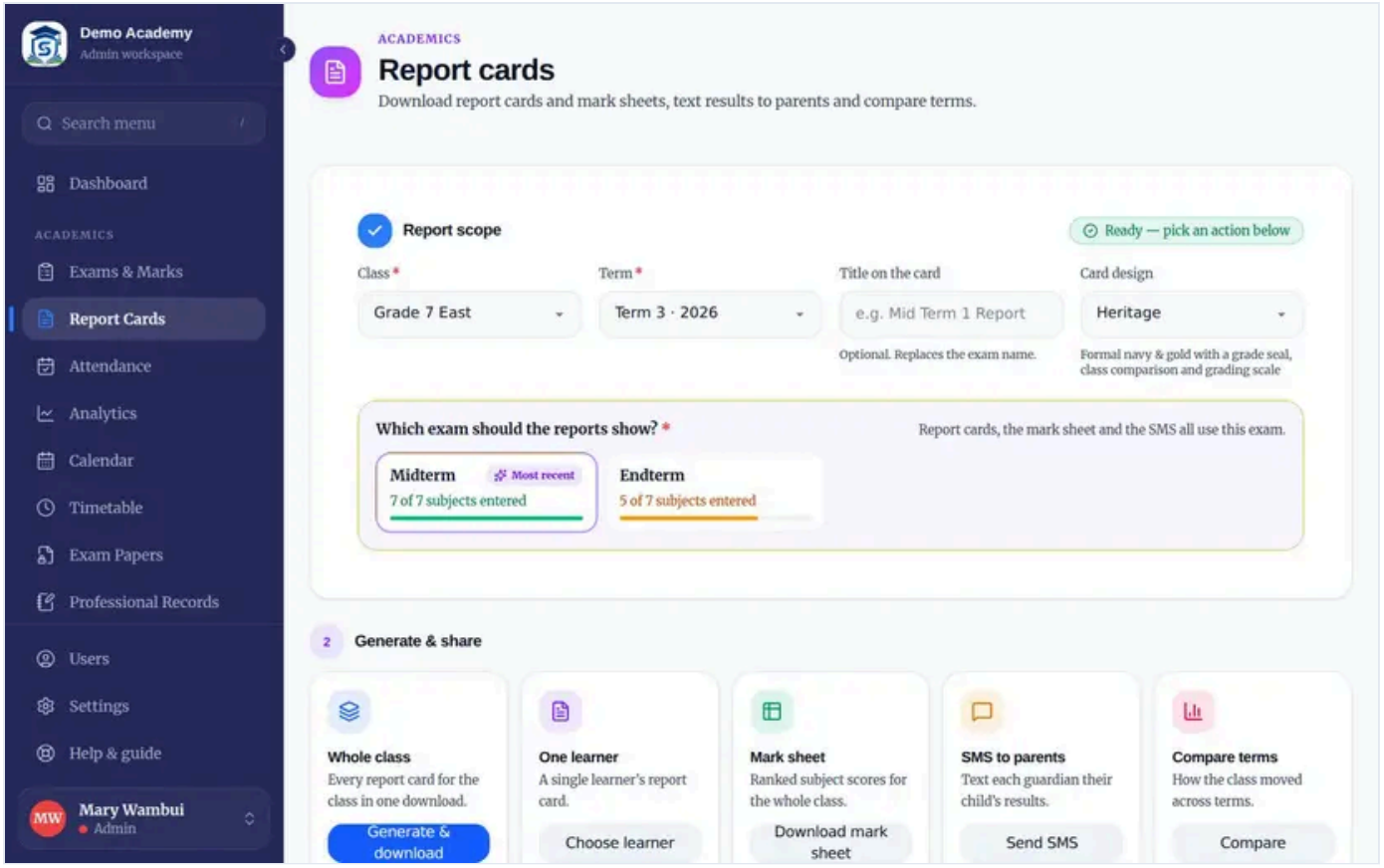
CHAPTER 7

Report cards and results for parents

Report Cards turns released marks into printable report cards and mark sheets, and texts results to parents.

7.1 Generate report cards

Choose the class, term and exam once; then pick what to produce.



Report cards: choose the scope, then an action.

1. **Choose the scope**
   Pick the class and the term. Optionally type a title for the card (for example “Mid Term 1 Report”) and choose a card design.

2. **Choose the exam**
   Each exam shows how many subjects have marks. “Most recent” is suggested. Report cards, the mark sheet and SMS all use this exam.

3. **Whole class**
   Press “Generate & download” for every learner’s card in one PDF, ready to print.

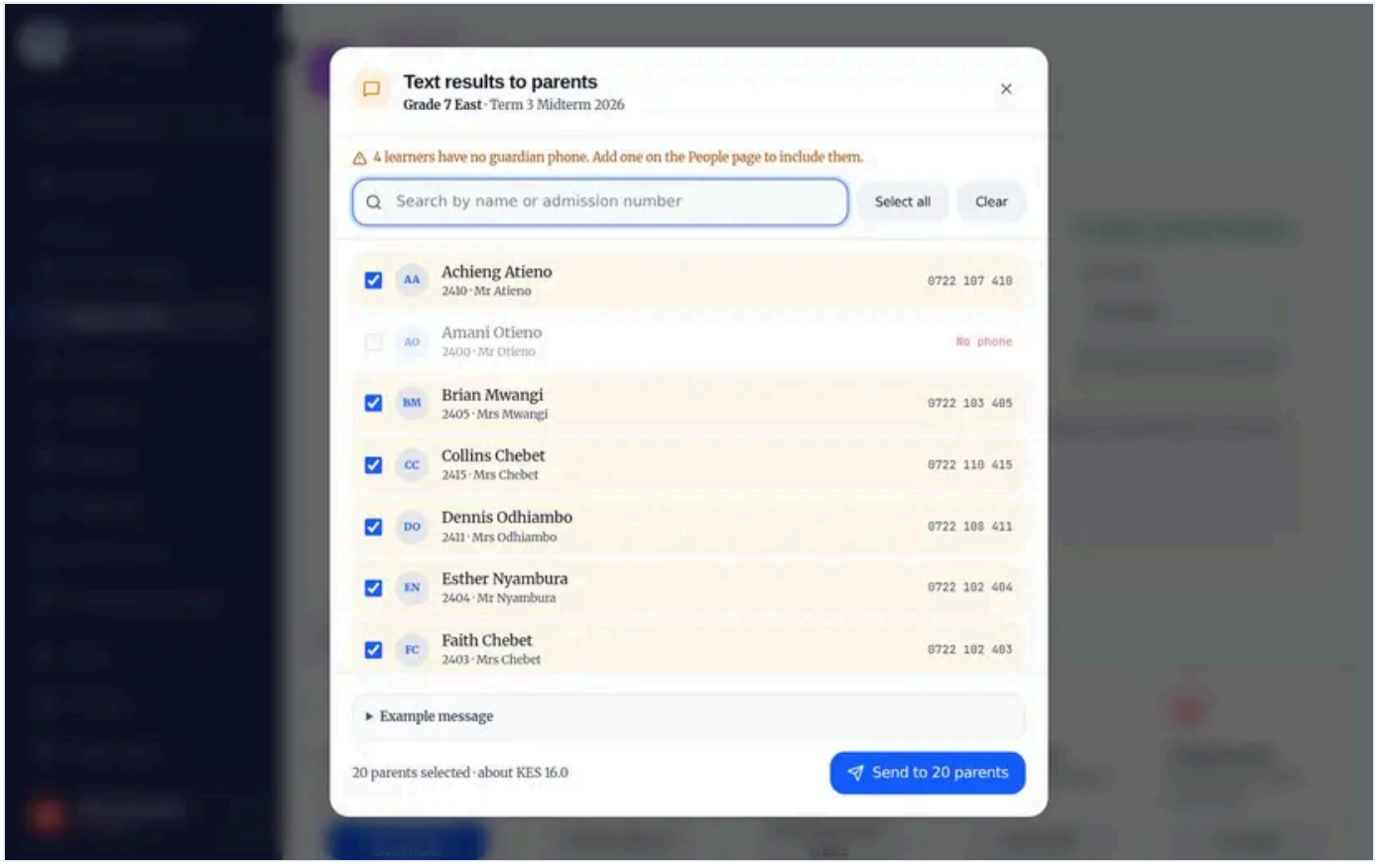
4. **One learner**
   Press “Choose learner” to download a single card.

5 **Mark sheet**
Downloads the ranked subject scores for the whole class.

- Class teacher and principal comments are added under “Comments on the cards” and print on each learner’s card.
- Each report card carries a QR code. Scanning it opens a page that shows the approved results, so parents and others can check a card is genuine.
- Senior School classes can split the class download by subject combination.
- Last year’s cards stay available after promotion: choose the year, the term and the class as it was then (for example Grade 7 East, 2026). The cards list the learners who were in it, wherever they are now, with that class, its class teacher and its positions.

7.2 Text results to parents

“SMS to parents” sends each guardian their child’s results for the chosen exam.



Choose which learners’ guardians to text, check the example message, and send.

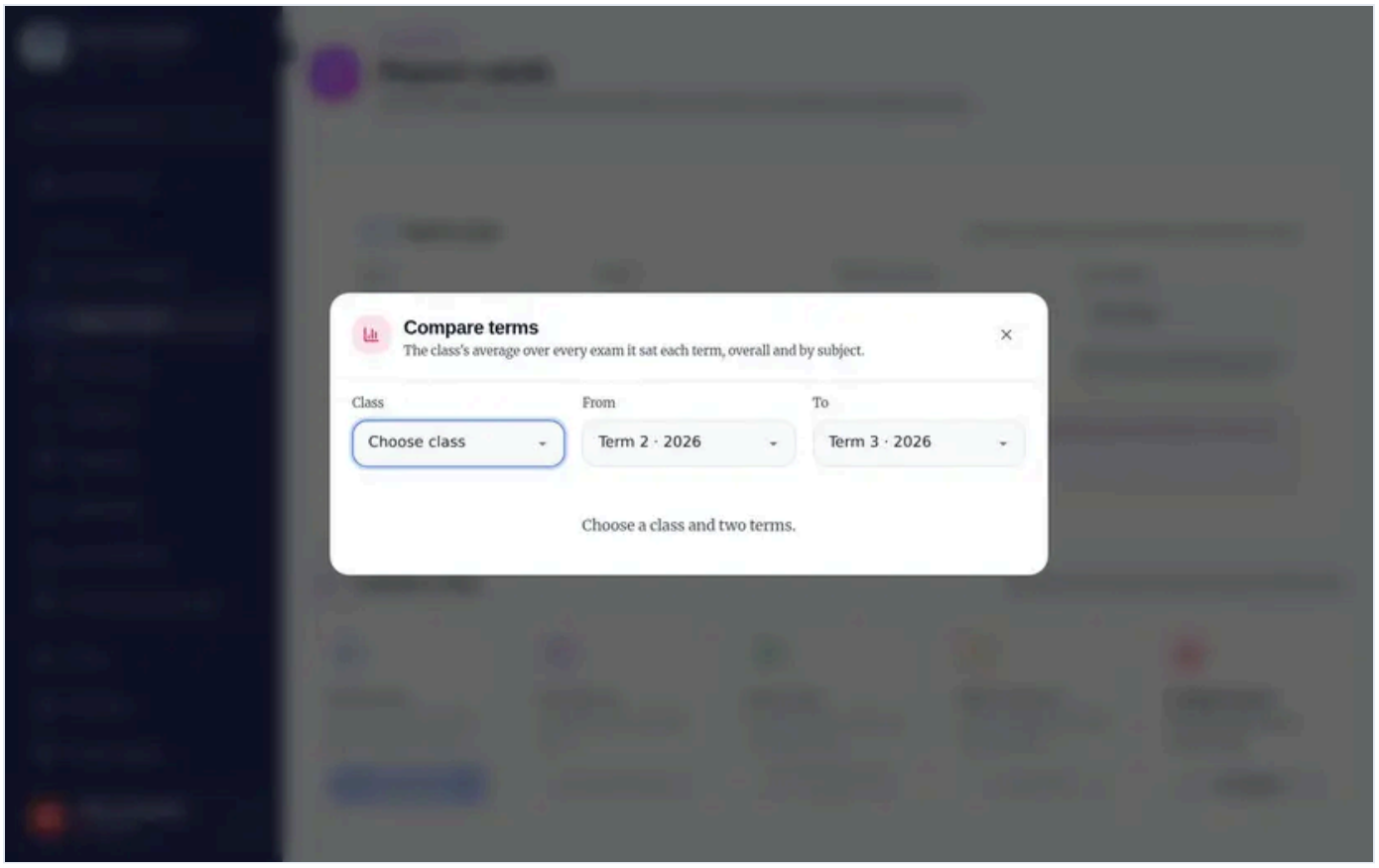
1 **Open it**
With the class, term and exam chosen, press “Send SMS”.

2 **Choose learners**
Everyone is selected; untick anyone to leave out. Learners without a guardian phone number are skipped.

3 **Check and send**
Read the example message, then confirm. SMS costs apply per message.

7.3 Compare terms

“Compare terms” shows how a class’s average and pass rate moved between two terms, overall and subject by subject.



Compare two terms for a class.

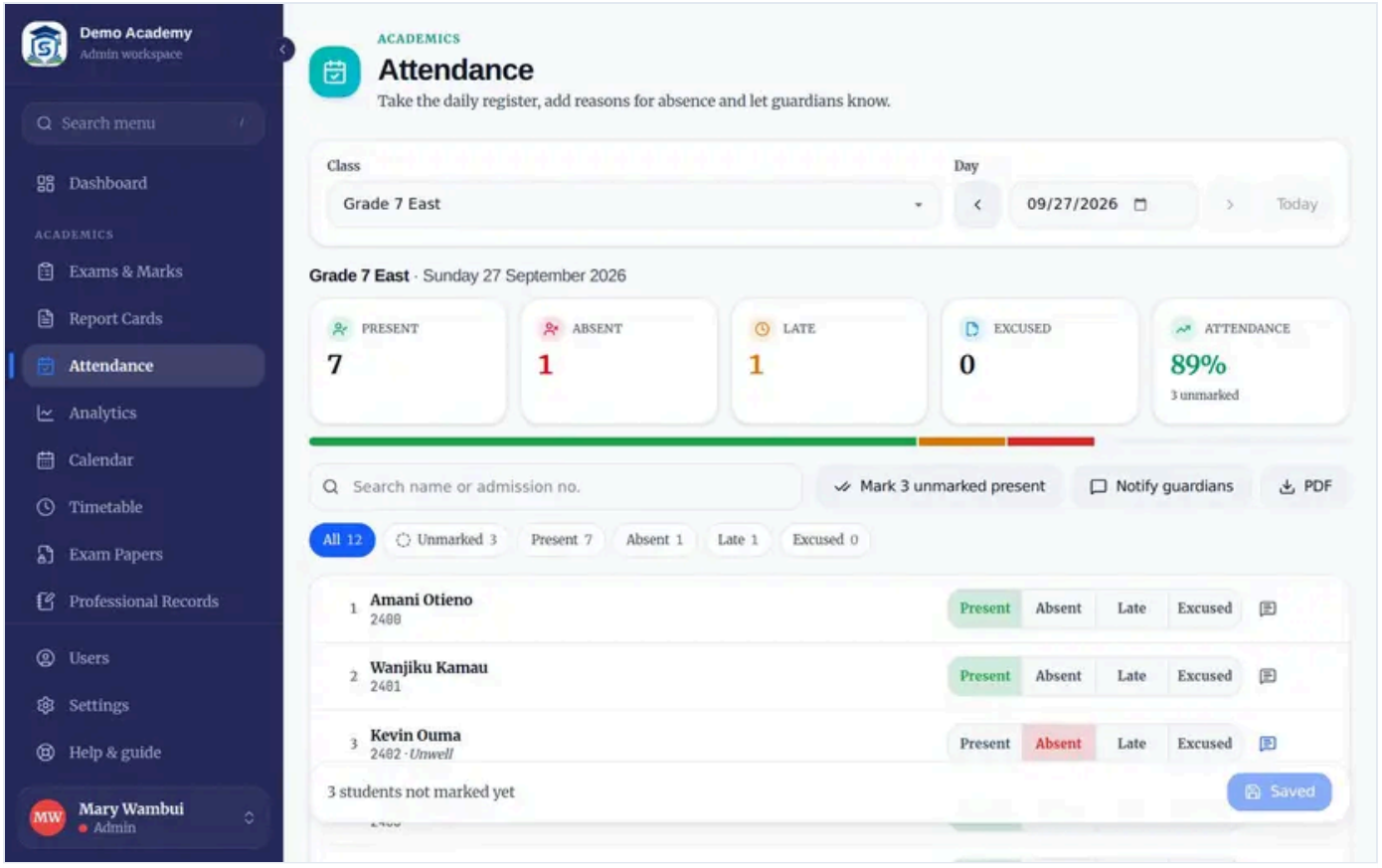
CHAPTER 8

Attendance

Class teachers usually take the register; administrators can take or correct it for any class, see the whole school on any day, and run reports for any class.

8.1 Take the daily register

Attendance holds one register per class per day. On the Register tab, mark each learner Present, Absent, Late or Excused, add a reason if you like, and let the parents of absent learners know by SMS.



The register: totals at the top, one row per learner, and a Save bar at the bottom.

1. **Open Attendance**
   Choose Attendance in the menu. The Register tab is open. A class teacher's own class opens straight away; otherwise pick the class.

2. **Check the day**
   Today is selected. The arrows step to the previous or next school day, skipping weekends; the date box picks any day. A weekend day is flagged if you choose one.

3. **Mark each learner**
   Tap Present, Absent, Late or Excused on each row. To save time, press "Mark N unmarked present" and then change only the exceptions.

4 **Add a reason (optional)**
The note icon at the end of a row adds a reason, such as “Unwell”. It shows under the learner’s name.

5 **Save**
Press Save at the bottom. Unsaved changes are kept if you switch class or day by mistake: you are asked first.

6 **Tell parents**
Press “Notify guardians” to text the parents of every learner marked absent: every linked parent and the number on the learner’s record. You see who will be texted before anything is sent, and nobody is texted twice for the same day.

> **Tip:** PDF downloads the day’s register for printing or filing.

8.2 The whole school on one day

The Whole school tab (administrators) shows any school day across every class: how many registers have been taken out of all classes, how many learners are absent and late, and the school’s attendance rate.

- Classes whose register has not been taken come first, marked “Not taken”, so you can remind their teachers.
- Each class shows a colour bar for the day (present, late, excused, absent), its rate and how many are absent.
- Tap a class to open its register for that day.
- The arrows move between school days, skipping weekends.

8.3 Attendance reports

The Reports tab shows one class over a period: the class’s attendance rate, how many registers were taken, and which learners attend less than 85% of the time. Administrators can choose any class; class teachers see their own.

1 **Choose the class and period**
Pick the class, then This week, This month, Last 30 days or Last 90 days, or set your own dates (up to 120 days).

2 **Read it**

Learners are listed lowest attendance first, each with their rate, absent, late and excused days, and a small square for every day the register was taken. Tick “Only below 85%” to see just the learners to follow up.

3 **Export**

“Excel” downloads the same grid: one column per day with P, A, L or E, the totals and each learner’s rate.

Tip: A day counts only if the class’s register was taken that day. A learner left unmarked on a day the register was taken counts as not marked, not absent.

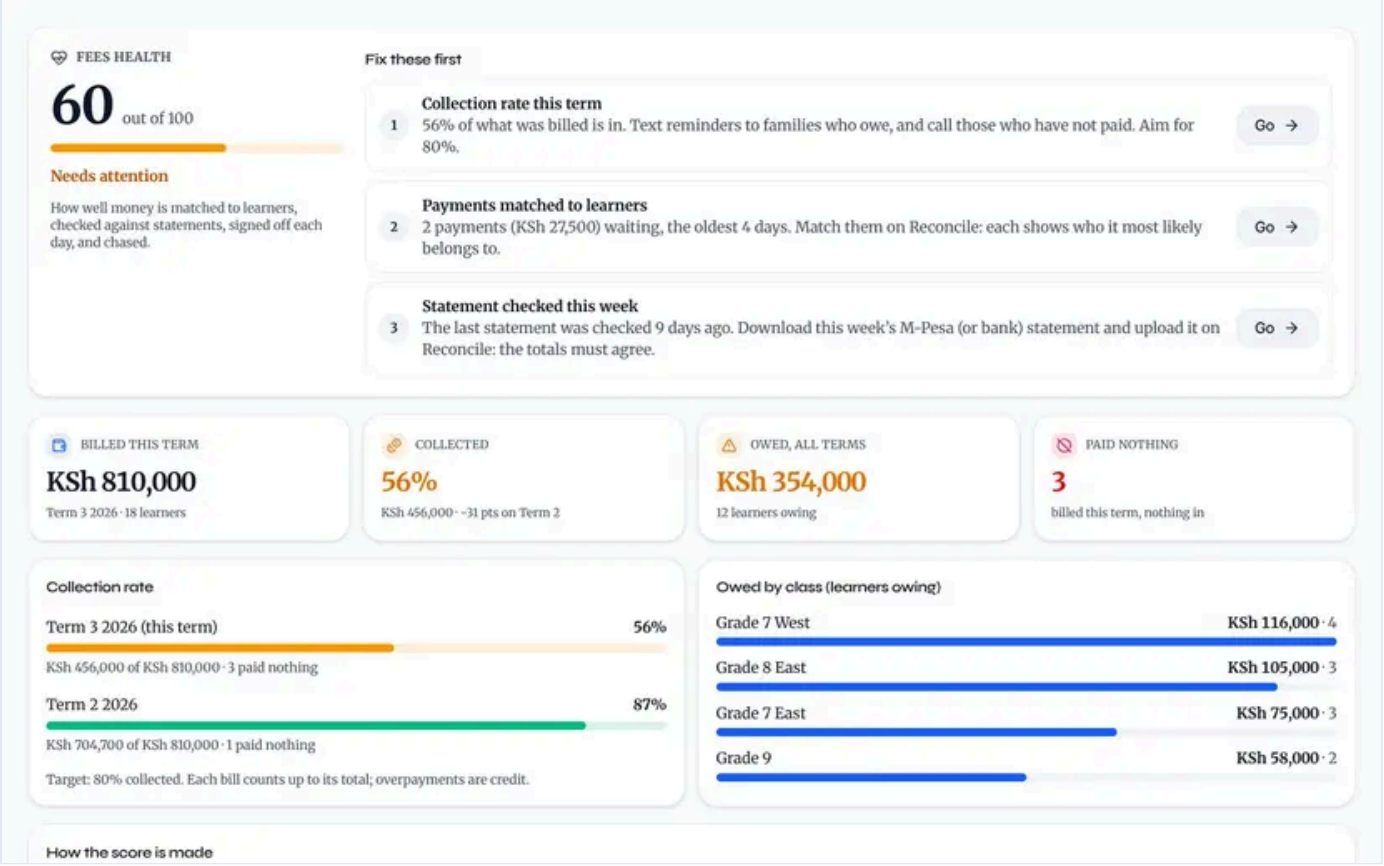
CHAPTER 9

Fees

Fees tracks what each learner has been billed, what they have paid and what is still owed, across every term. Administrators, and staff given the Bursar or Accountant duty, see the Fees page; learners and linked parents see their own fees and can pay online. Billing from fee structures, bursaries and expenses are in the Bursar and finance guide.

9.1 The fees overview and health score

Finance staff open Fees on the Overview: a health score out of 100 for how the school's money is kept, the three fixes that would lift it most, this term's collection rate against last term's, what is owed by class, and how many families have paid nothing this term.

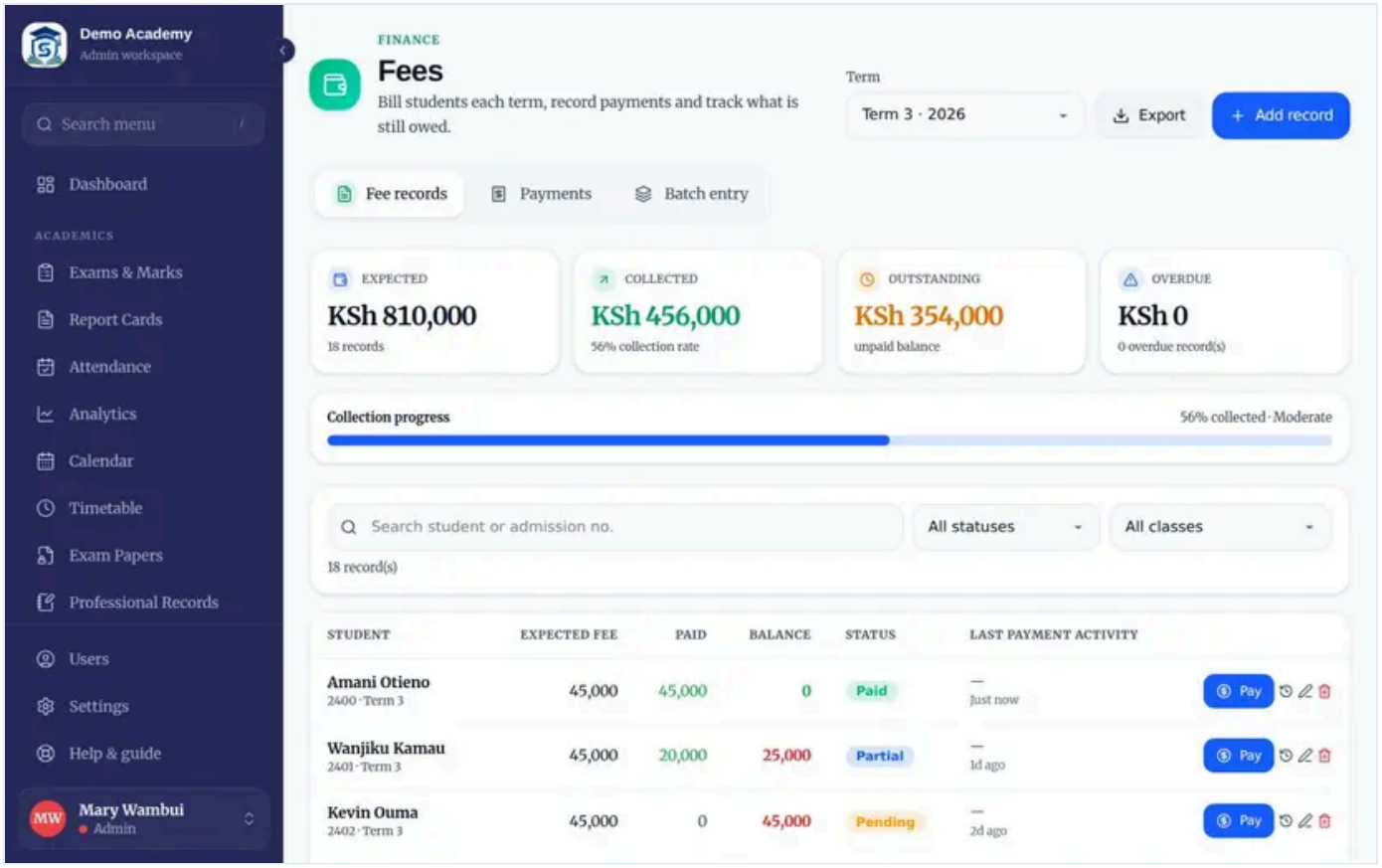


Fees → Overview: the score, the three fixes to make first, and this term against last term.

- The score adds up seven checks: the collection rate (30 points), payments matched to learners (15), a statement checked in the last week (15), each day's takings signed off (15), families who have paid something (10), promises kept (5) and parents with a phone (10).
- Each fix says what was found and what to do, with a Go button to the tab where it is done.
- Early in a term the collection target grows with the weeks, and families who have not paid yet do not count against the score.

9.2 Fee records

The Fee records tab shows the chosen term's totals (expected, collected, outstanding, overdue), a collection progress bar, and one row per learner.



Fees → Fee records for the chosen term.

- Choose the term at the top. Search by learner or admission number, or filter by status and class.
- Click a learner's row to open their fee account (below).
- Each row also has Pay (record a payment), payment history with receipts, edit and delete. "Add record" bills one learner; "Export" downloads the list as a spreadsheet.
- Finance staff get links from Fees to fee structures and invoicing, the payment channels, and linking a class's parents.

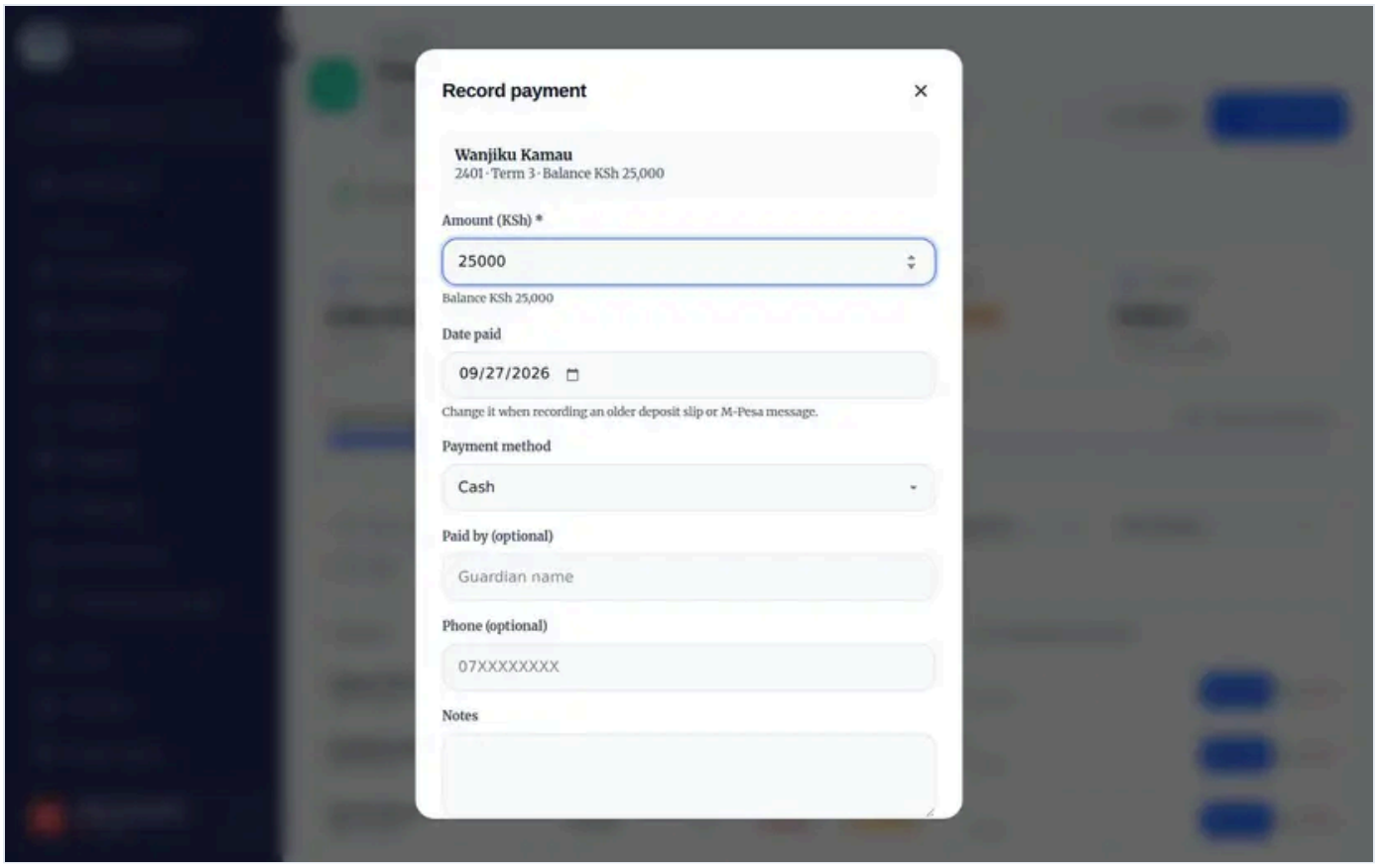
9.3 A learner's fee account and statement

A learner's fee account puts everything about their fees in one place: what they owe across every term (arrears carried forward), each term's bill with its vote heads and bursaries, every payment with its receipt, and the parents to call or text.

1. **Open it**
   Click the learner's row on Fee records or on Who owes.
2. **Read the balance**
   The top shows the balance due (or credit) across all terms, what was billed and paid, and any arrears from earlier terms.
3. **Call the parent**
   The parents linked to the learner, and the contact on their record, are listed with their phone numbers. If nobody is linked you can link a parent on the spot.
4. **Record a payment**
   "Record payment" records money against the oldest term still owing, so arrears clear before the current bill.
5. **Give the statement**
   "Statement" downloads a PDF listing every charge, bursary and payment with a running balance, and how to pay (the Paybill with the admission number as the account, and bank accounts). Hand it to a parent or send it on WhatsApp.

9.4 Record a payment

For cash, cheques, bank deposits and M-Pesa messages you receive yourself. Payments made online from the learner's or a parent's Fees page are recorded automatically.



Record payment: the amount is filled with the balance; change it for a part payment.

1. **Press Pay**
   On the learner's row, or "Record payment" in their fee account.

2. **Enter the payment**
   Type the amount, the date paid (change it when recording an older slip), the method and, optionally, who paid and a note.

3. **Give the reference**
   Every payment that is not cash needs what traces it: the M-Pesa code from the message (10 letters and numbers), the bank slip or transaction number, or the cheque number. Skulbase refuses a code or slip number already recorded, so the same money cannot be entered twice.

4. **Save**
   The balance updates straight away, and the receipt is in the payment history and the fee account.

⚠ **Good to know:** The bursar or an administrator can void a payment recorded by mistake from the payment history, and must say why (an M-Pesa reversal, entered twice, a bounced cheque). The receipt then shows as voided, with who voided it, when and why; the day book shows it too.

9.5 Receipts and checking one is genuine

Every completed payment has an A5 receipt, ready to print or share. It shows who paid for which learner, the amount in figures and words, the M-Pesa or bank code, what the payment paid for (the term's vote heads, in priority order), the term balance, arrears from earlier terms and the total still due, all as they stood right after the payment, so a reprint matches the original.

- The receipt carries the school's contacts and a QR code. Scanning it opens a Skulbase page that says whether the receipt is genuine, voided or not yet confirmed, with the receipt number, amount, date and the learner's first name only.
- Receipts are only issued for confirmed payments. An online payment still waiting for confirmation has no receipt yet.

9.6 One payment for two children

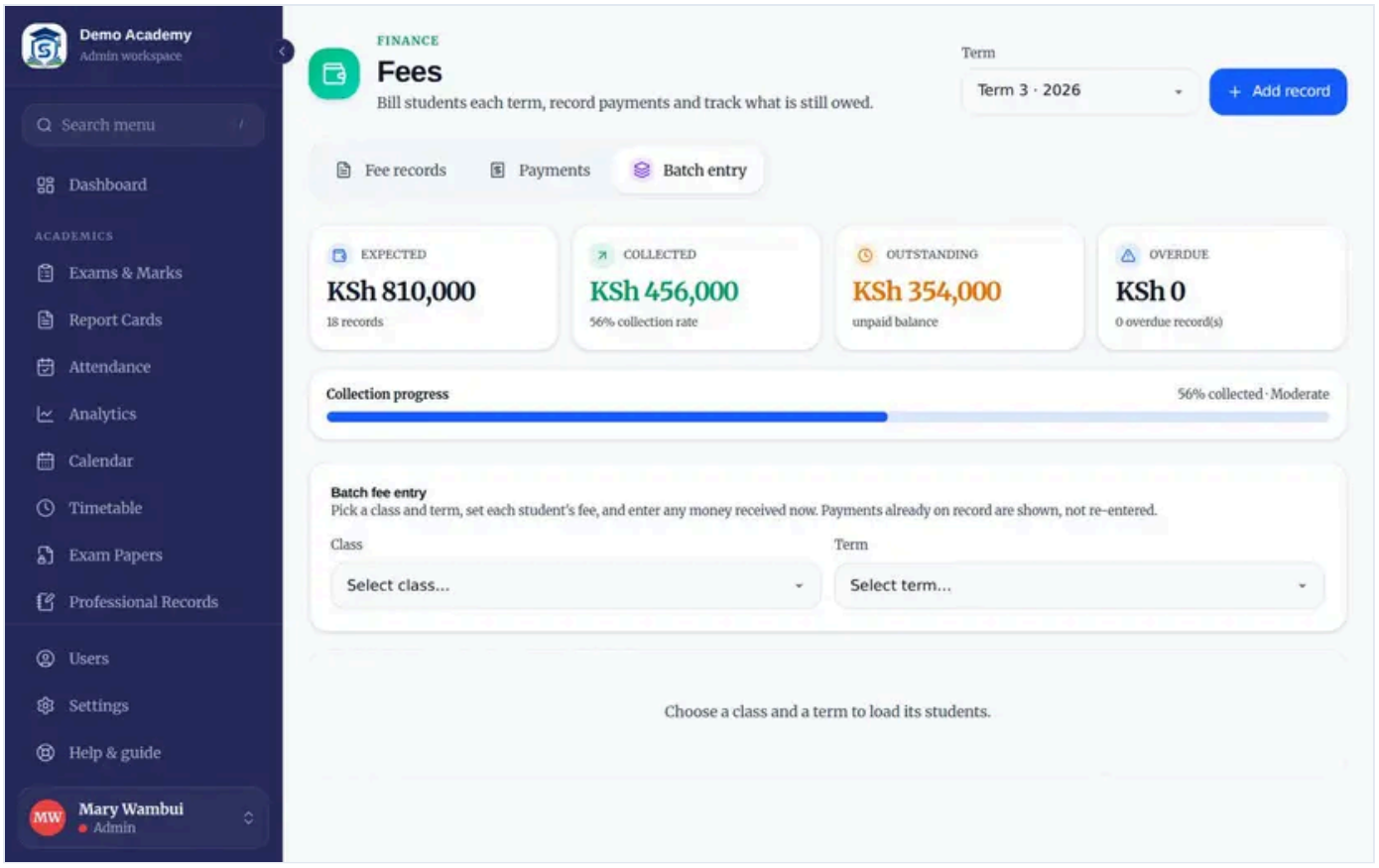
A parent often pays for two children in one M-Pesa payment, with only one child's admission number as the account. The money lands on that child. Move the other child's part across instead of voiding and re-entering it.

1. **Open the payment history**
   On the child the money went to, open the payment history and press the share button beside the payment.
2. **Pick the brother or sister**
   Learners sharing a parent's phone are offered first; you can also search for anyone else.
3. **Enter their share**
   Half is filled in; change it if the parent says otherwise. Press Share.

- The other child gets their own receipt, carrying the same M-Pesa code; the first receipt keeps the rest.
- Voiding a share gives its money back to the payment it came from. Voiding the original payment (a reversal) voids its shares with it.

9.7 Bill a whole class at once

The Batch entry tab bills every learner in a class for the term in one go. Schools with fee structures usually bill from Billing → Invoicing instead.

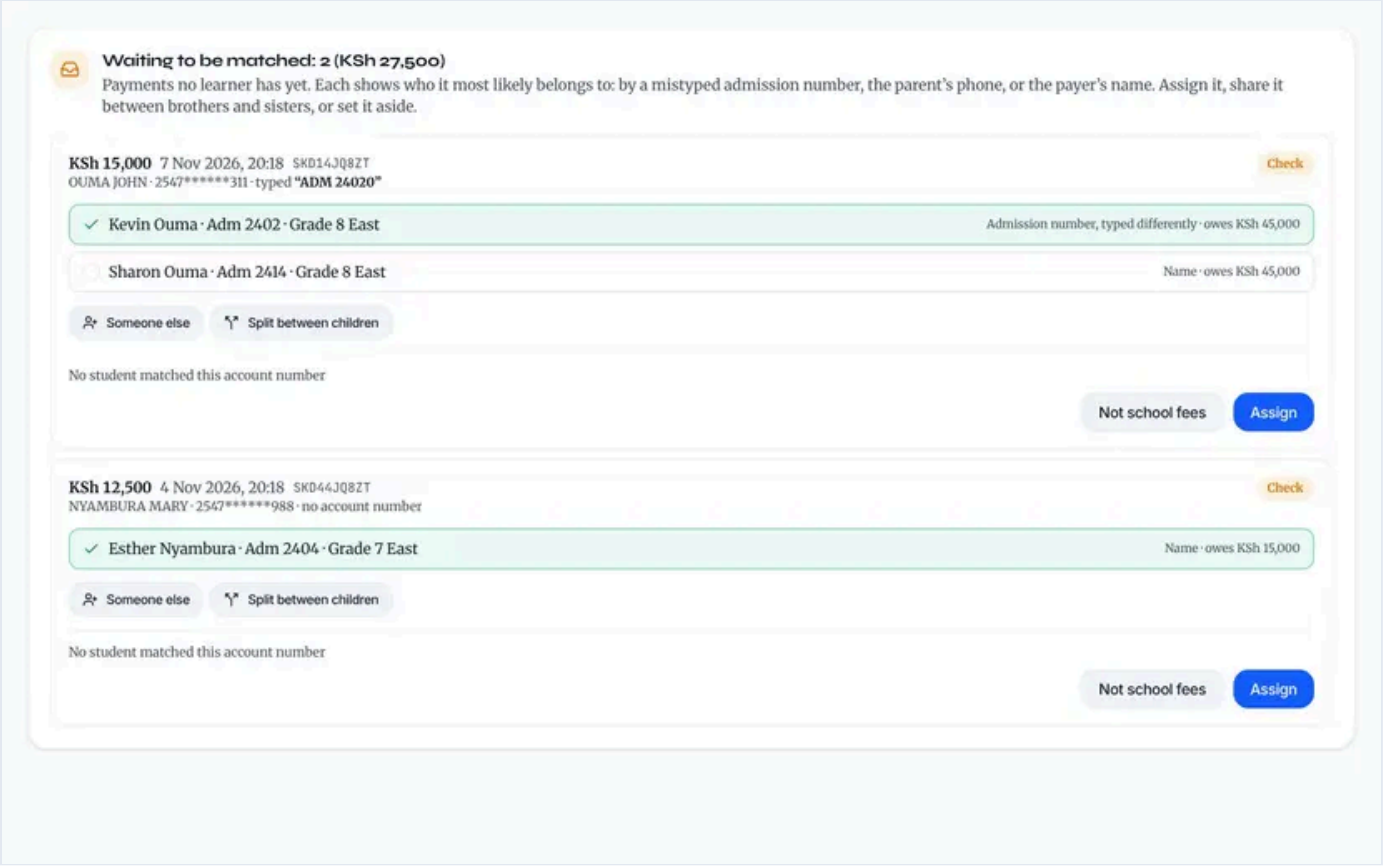


Fees → Batch entry.

1. **Choose the class and term**
   Every active learner in the class is listed.
2. **Set the fee**
   Type the fee once and press Apply to fill it for everyone, and set one due date. Change any learner's fee individually if needed.
3. **Record payments now (optional)**
   Enter any payment already received in "Payment now"; "Balance after" updates as you type.
4. **Save all**
   Press "Save all". Learners already billed for the term keep their record and are updated rather than billed twice.

9.8 Reconcile: matching every payment to a learner

Parents pay the Paybill with the learner's admission number as the account. When a payment cannot be matched (a typo, a missing account number, a learner not billed yet) it waits on the Reconcile tab, with the learners it most likely belongs to. Once a week, check the M-Pesa or bank statement against Skulbase there too.



Fees → Reconcile: each payment shows who it most likely belongs to.

1. **Match what is waiting**
   Each payment lists likely learners: an admission number typed differently, the parent's phone, or the payer's name. Pick one (or "Someone else" to search) and press Assign. For two children in one payment, press "Split between children" and set each share.

2. **Set aside what is not fees**
   Money paid to the wrong Paybill and refunded, or a supplier's deposit: press "Not school fees" and say why. It leaves the list and every total, and keeps who did it.

3. **Check the statement**
   Download the M-Pesa statement (or the bank statement) as Excel or CSV and upload it under "Check a statement". Skulbase reads every payment in, finds those already in Skulbase by their code, and matches the rest by admission number.

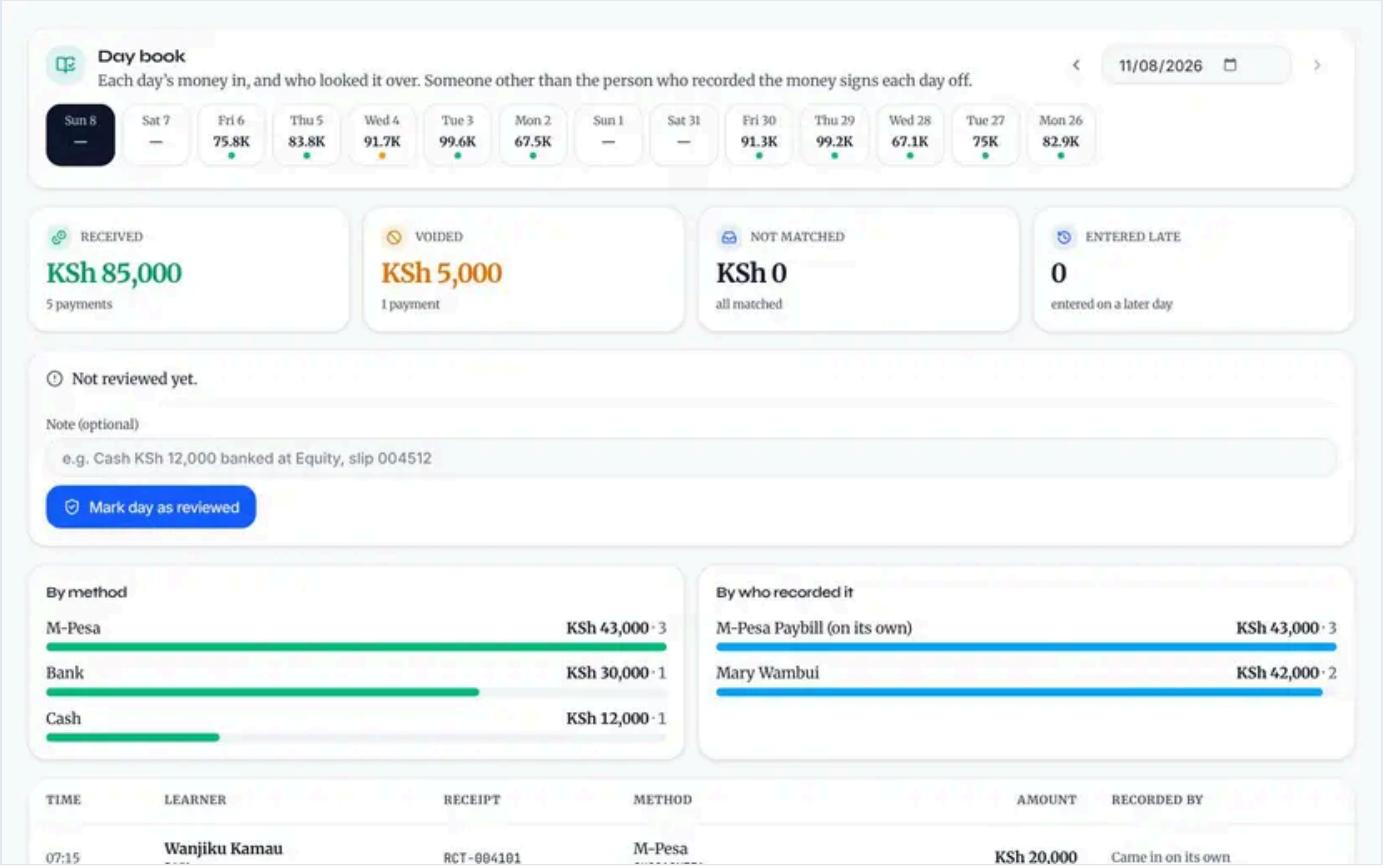
4. **Review and save**
   Lines matched by admission number are ready; check the others, record them to a learner, leave them unmatched to chase, or mark them not school fees. The totals must agree before you save: the statement total equals what is recorded, already in, left unmatched and set aside.

- Skulbase also lists payments in Skulbase for the statement's dates that the statement does not show: check each one (a cash payment entered as M-Pesa, or a wrong code).
- Each statement checked is kept in the history, with who uploaded it and how its money was accounted for.

- Matching unmatched payments the same week, before parents ask, keeps balances and reminders right.

9.9 The day book: signing off each day

The Day book shows one day's money in: every payment (voided ones too), the totals by method and by who recorded them, money still to match, and payments entered on a later day than they were paid. Someone other than the person who recorded the money looks it over and signs the day off.



Fees → Day book: the day's takings, by method and by who recorded them, and its sign-off.

1. **Pick the day**
   Today opens first. The strip of recent days shows each day's takings, with a green dot for a signed-off day and an amber one for a day that changed after it was signed.

2. **Look it over**
   Compare the cash total with the cash banked and the M-Pesa total with the statement; check the voided and late entries.

3. **Sign it off**
   Add a note if useful (for example the bank slip number) and press "Mark day as reviewed". Only the bursar or an administrator can sign.

- If you recorded some of the day's payments yourself, Skulbase asks you to confirm you are checking your own entries, and the sign-off says so. Better: ask the head or a second person to sign that day.
- A payment recorded or voided after the sign-off marks the day as changed, with what it was and what it is now, until it is signed again.

9.10 Who owes, and fee reminders

The Who owes tab lists every learner owing across all their terms, most owed first: how much, how long it has been overdue, how many terms are owing, when they last paid, and the parent to call (a linked parent before the contact on the learner's record).

1. **Narrow it down**
   Filter by class, and set "Over KSh" to leave out small balances. The figures above show how many learners owe, the total owed (arrears included) and how many have no parent phone.
2. **Follow one up**
   Tap a phone number to call, or a learner to open their fee account.
3. **Export**
   "Excel" downloads the list for the board or the class teachers.
4. **Text reminders**
   Press "Text reminders". Skulbase first says how many messages will go to the parents of how many learners, and how many owing learners have no number at all. Confirm to send.
5. **Chase the right families first**
   The buttons above the list narrow it to families who have paid nothing this term, to those whose promise to pay was broken, and to those who have promised. The Follow-up column shows each family's latest promise, or when they were last contacted.

- Each reminder gives the learner's balance across all terms and, when the school takes M-Pesa, the Paybill and account number.
- Reminders reach every linked parent as well as the number on the learner's record, once each.
- Learners with no parent phone are counted, not texted. Link their parents under Parent accounts.

9.11 Following up arrears: notes and promises to pay

Chase arrears early in the term, and write down what was said. In a learner's fee account, "Follow-ups" keeps each call, message or meeting, and each promise to pay with its amount and date.

1. **Add a note**
   Press Add, choose “Note of a contact”, tap a quick note (Called, no answer; Sent a reminder SMS…) or write what was said, and save.

2. **Write down a promise**
   Choose “Promise to pay”, enter the amount and the date the family will pay by, and save.

- Skulbase checks each promise against the payments: it shows as Promised until the date, Promise kept once the amount is in, or Promise broken if the date passes short.
- Who owes shows the latest promise or contact for every family, and can list only the broken promises.
- Accountants and bursars can write follow-ups; the bursar or an administrator can remove one written by mistake.

9.12 Collections report

The Collections tab shows the money received over a period: today, the last 7 days, this month, the last 30 days or any dates. It gives the total, the number of payments and the daily average, split by method (M-Pesa, cash, bank), by class and by day. Use it for daily banking and the head’s weekly report.

9.13 The payments log

The Payments tab lists every payment received, filtered by date, method, automatic or manual and status, with Export beside the search. It shows each payment’s reference (M-Pesa code, bank slip or cheque number), and who voided a voided one. Payments not yet matched to a learner are on the Reconcile tab.

9.14 A fee routine that keeps the books right

The habits behind a clean fees ledger, and where each is done in Skulbase.

- Tell parents to pay the Paybill with the admission number as the account; the statement and reminders give it.
- Every day: sign off the day’s takings in the Day book, ideally by someone who did not record them.
- Every week: match what is waiting and check the M-Pesa and bank statements on Reconcile, so Skulbase and the statement agree.
- From the first weeks of term: chase families who have paid nothing, and write down every promise to pay.

- Give a receipt for every payment, with its reference; void with a reason, never delete.
- Watch the health score on the Overview: its three fixes say what to do next.

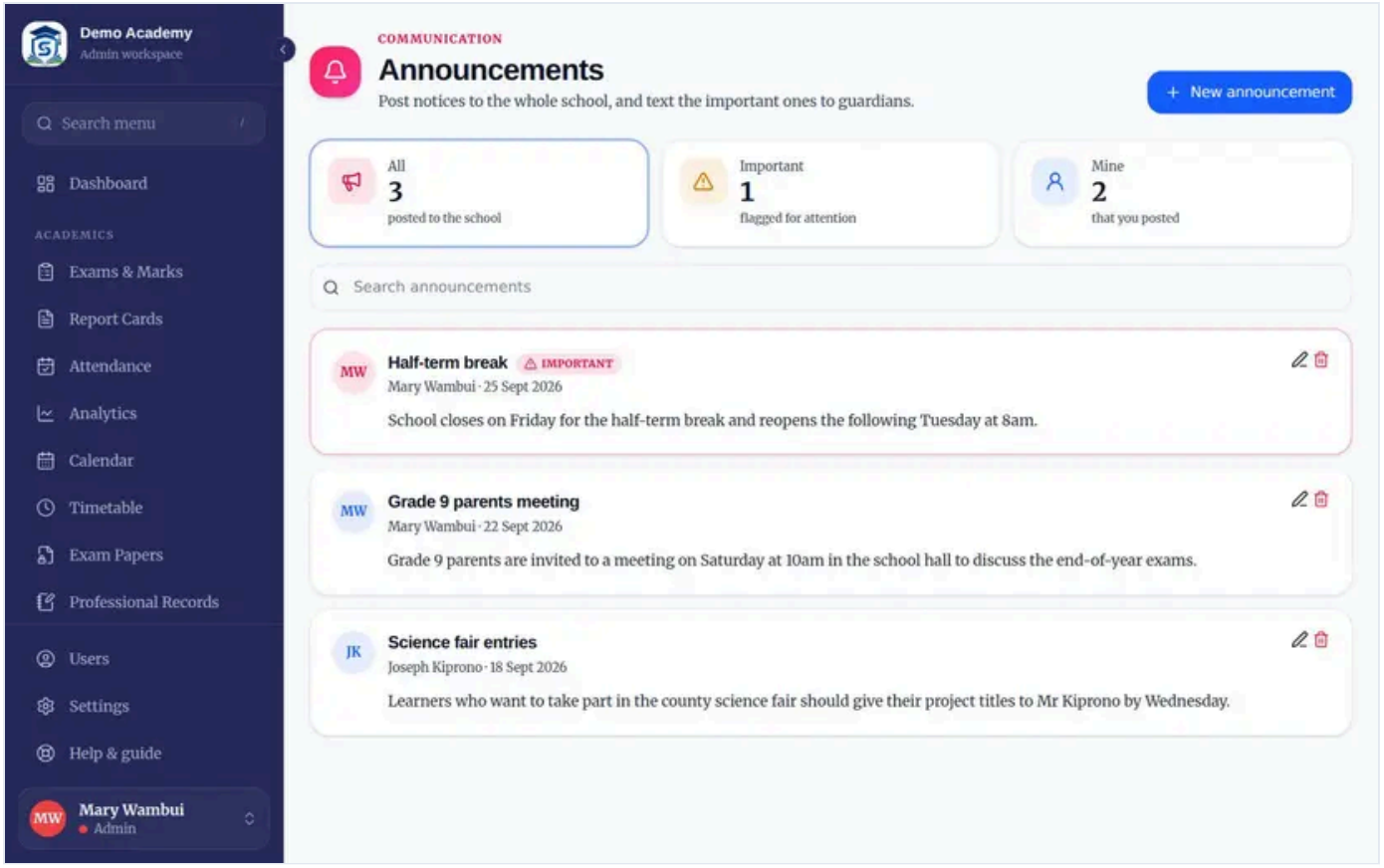
CHAPTER 10

Announcements and homework

Keep staff, learners and parents informed, and see all homework set across the school.

10.1 Post announcements

Announcements are notices for the whole school. They show on the Announcements page and on learners' dashboards.



Announcements: important ones are highlighted.

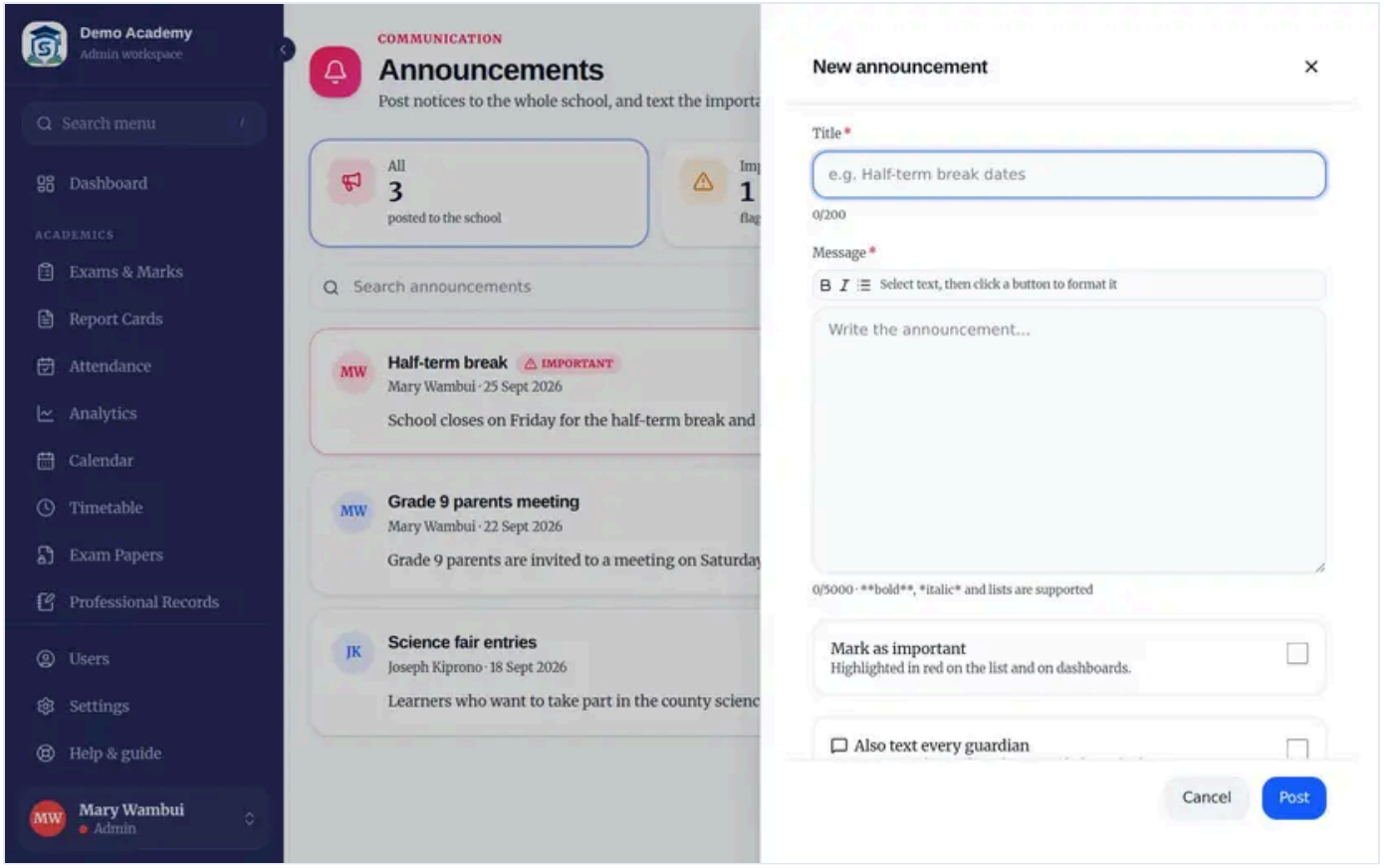
1. **Start one**
   On Announcements press "New announcement".
2. **Write it**
   Give it a short title (for example "Half-term break dates") and the message.
3. **Mark it important (optional)**
   Important announcements are highlighted in red on the list and on dashboards.
4. **Text guardians too (optional)**
   Tick "Also text every guardian" to send it as one SMS to each guardian phone on file for active learners. SMS costs apply, and you are shown how many messages will go out.

5 **Post**
Press Post. You can edit or delete your own announcements later from the list.

- Search, or filter to Important or to the ones you posted.

10.2 Writing an announcement

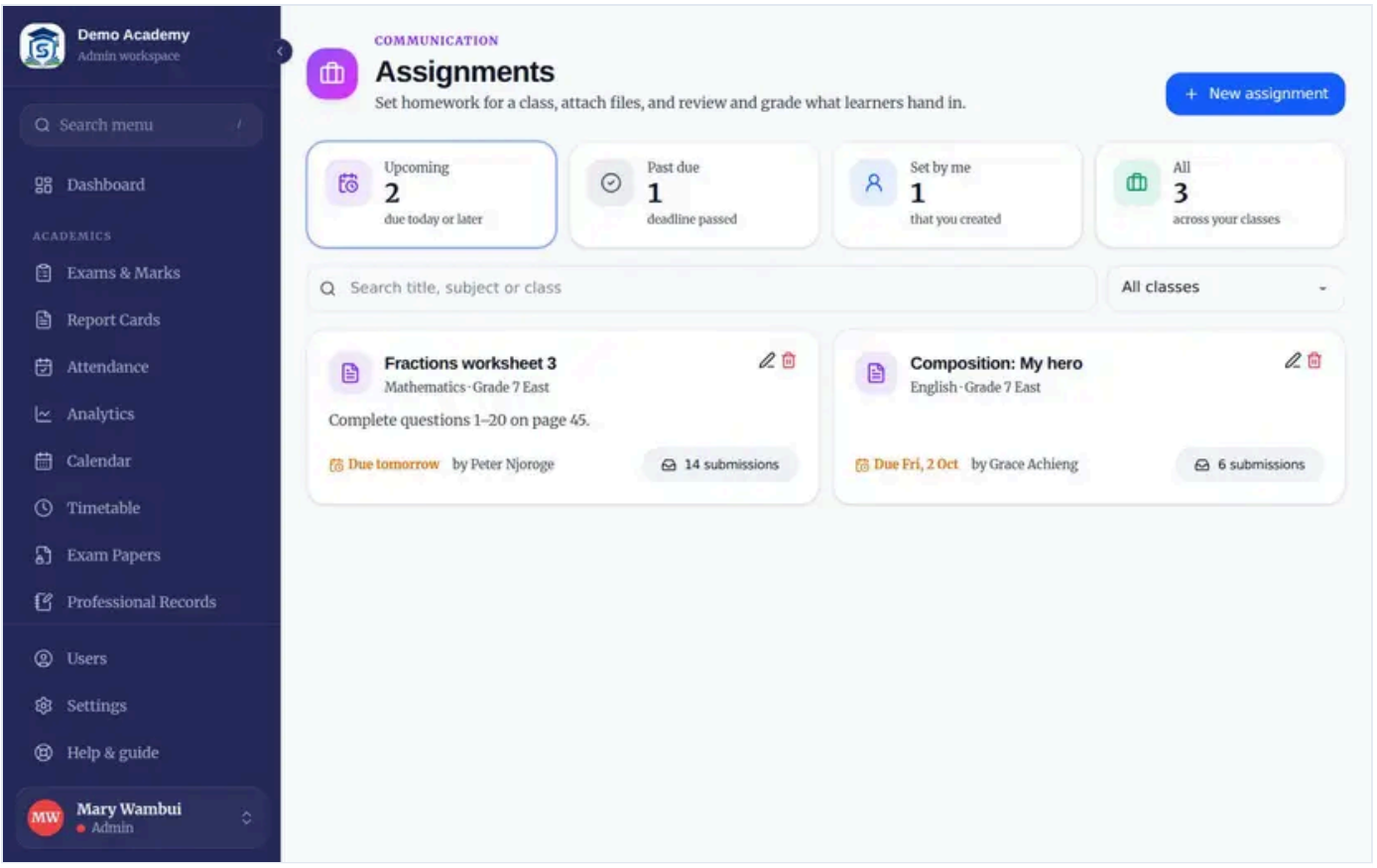
Keep the title short; it is what people see first on their dashboards and in the SMS.



A new announcement, with the option to text every guardian.

10.3 Set homework and mark it

Assignments is where homework is set for a class. Learners see it on their dashboard, hand it in there (typed or as a file), and you grade it here.



Assignments: every piece of homework set across the school.

1. **Set an assignment**
   Press “New assignment”. Choose the class and subject, give it a title and a due date, add instructions, and attach a file (up to 10 MB) if you like.

2. **Follow progress**
   The tiles at the top filter to Upcoming, Past due, Set by me and All. Each card shows how many learners have handed in.

3. **Mark the work**
   Open the hand-ins, read each learner’s answer or open their file, and give a grade from 0 to 100 with optional feedback. Learners see the grade and feedback on their dashboard.

- Work is due at the end of the due date, not at midnight before it.
- Teachers can edit and grade only the assignments they set; administrators can manage all of them.
- Once you have graded a hand-in, the learner can no longer replace it.

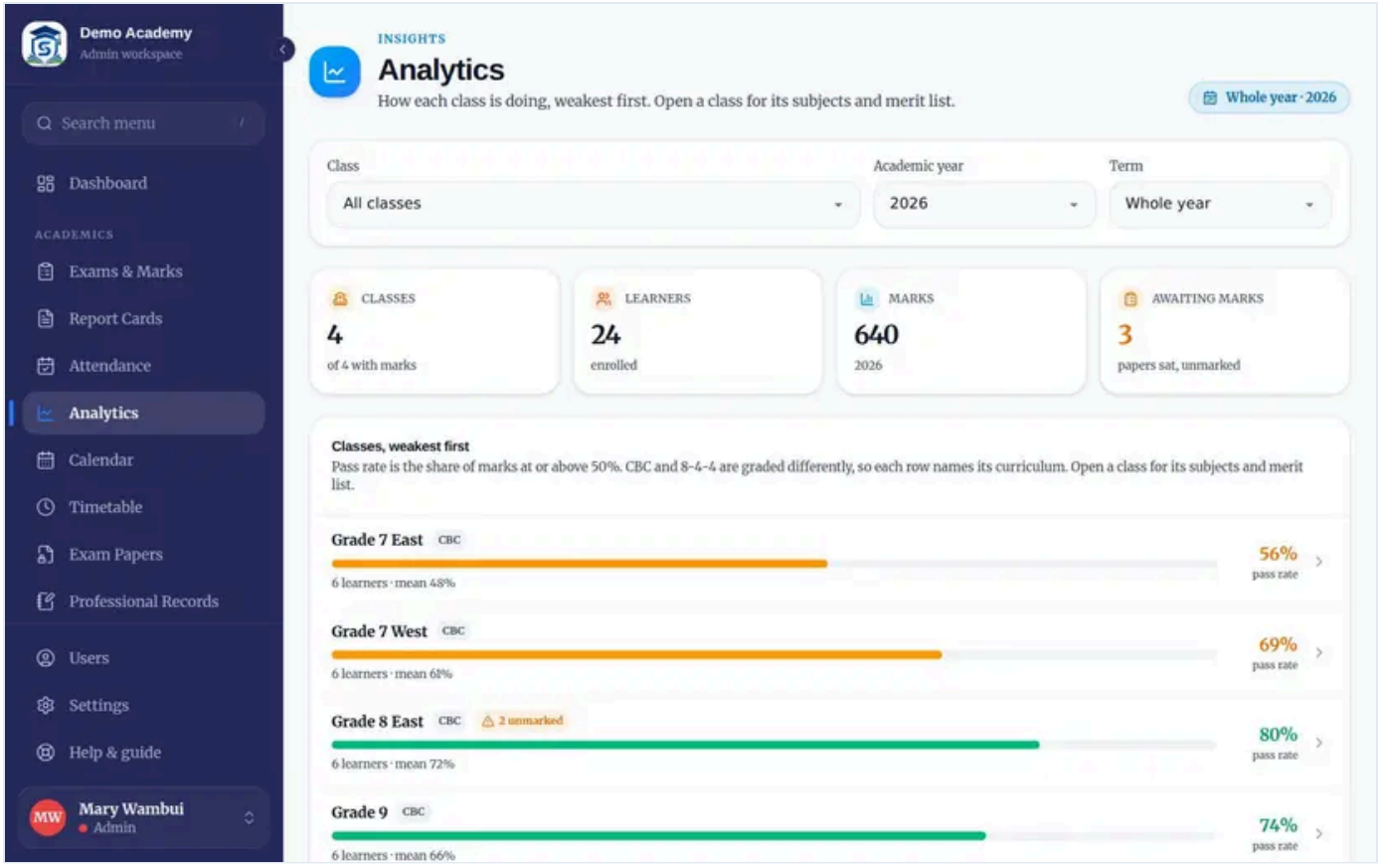
CHAPTER 11

Analytics

Analytics compares performance across the school: class by class, subject by subject, term by term.

11.1 Reading Analytics

Choose a class (or all classes), an academic year and a term. The page shows averages and pass rates against your pass mark, which classes and subjects are strongest and weakest, and which classes still have exams to mark.



Analytics for the whole school.

> **Tip:** The filters are kept in the page address, so you can bookmark or share a view (for example Grade 8, Term 2).

CHAPTER 12

Other modules

Each optional module has its own illustrated guide for the people who run it, and you can open every one of them as administrator. They are all under Help & guide and at skulbase.com/help.

12.1 Where each module is explained

Share the right guide with each person when you assign their duty.

- Calendar, timetable, exam paper bank, professional records and CBC assessment: the Academic leadership guide (and the teacher guides for the teacher side).
- Billing (vote heads, fee structures, invoicing, bursaries) and expenses: the Bursar and finance guide.
- Boarding (roll calls, exeats, dorms, inspections) and discipline: the Boarding and discipline guide.
- Health and the sick bay: the School nurse guide.
- Transport and live bus tracking: the Transport guide.
- Library, inventory and staff leave: the Library, stores and HR guide.
- The parent portal: the Parent guide.

CHAPTER 13

End of the year

When the academic year is over, promote learners in one step, then set up the new year.

13.1 Promote learners

Classes → "Promote students" moves every grade up a class, archives learners who complete the school, and leaves Grade 9s pending until Senior School placement is out, all at once. It works the same on the website and in the phone app.

1. **Open it**
   On Classes, press "Promote students". It closes the year now ending (in January, the one just ended); if your school has several years on record, pick another under "Year being closed". Each grade has a card saying what happens to it: "Moves up" (to the next grade), "Pending placement" (Grade 9, whose learners are placed into Senior School nationally), "Awaits Grade 11" (a top class whose next grade you have not added yet), or "Completes here" / "Candidates" (your last grade, for example Grade 12 or Form 4).

2. **Choose where each class goes**
   For a grade that moves up, choose the class each stream moves into, for example Grade 7 East to Grade 8 East.

3. **Decide the exceptions**
   Any learner can instead repeat the year or be marked as transferred out. Grade 9 learners are left pending unless you mark them now, so they never hold up the rest of the school.

4. **Promote**
   Press "Promote learners" and confirm. Nothing changes until you do. Learners who complete or leave are archived as graduated or transferred; pending learners keep their class and records but drop off class lists, attendance, fees and SMS.

5. **Decide the pending learners**
   When Senior School placement is out (or once you add the missing grade), open "Promote students" again. Only the pending learners are listed: mark who joins your Grade 10 and who leaves, then press "Decide". Anyone you are not sure of stays pending.

6. **Set up the new year**
   Follow "Next: set up the new year": add the new academic year and its terms in Settings, make Term 1 current, and enrol new learners on People.

- Each learner is promoted once a year. "Undo promotion" puts everyone back if something was wrong; after deciding pending learners, "Undo last decisions" puts just those back to pending.
- People shows pending learners under the status "Pending promotion".
- Report cards from before the promotion still print for the classes learners were in then, and each learner's profile lists every term's card under that class.

⚠ **Good to know:** Learners' classes change straight away, so check the last term's marks are complete before you promote.

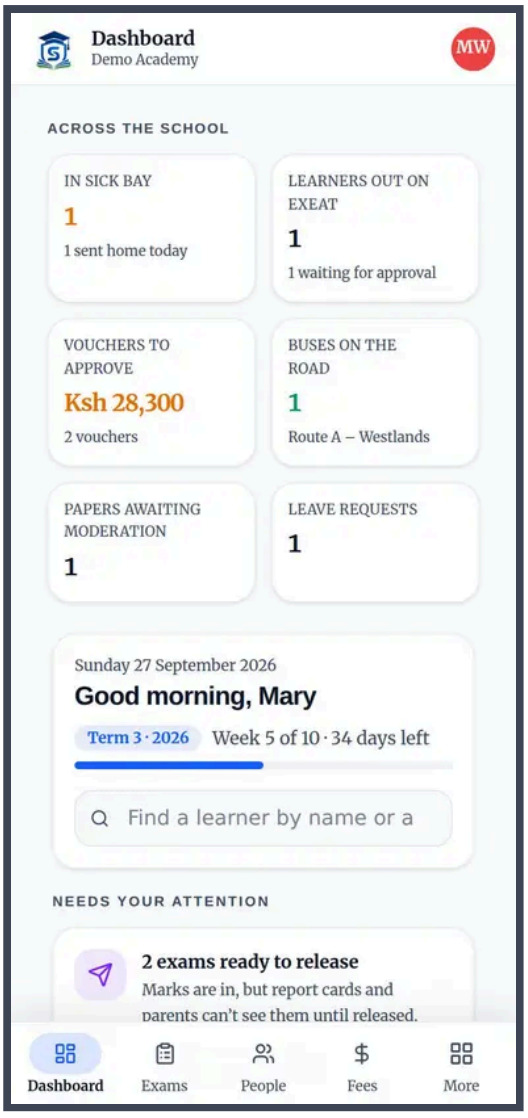
CHAPTER 14

On your phone

Skulbase works fully on a phone.

14.1 Using Skulbase on a phone

Every page works on a phone, in the browser or in the Skulbase app. Tables turn into cards, the main pages sit in a bar along the bottom, and everything else is under More.



The administrator dashboard on a phone. The bottom bar holds Dashboard, Exams, People and Fees; everything else is under More.

- In the browser, use a current version of Chrome, Safari or Samsung Internet, and save skulbase.com to your home screen.
- The Skulbase app signs in with the same account and shows the same pages. More lists every other page in one grid, with a search box to find one by name.

- The app updates itself in the background. When an update is ready it offers “Restart now”; otherwise it opens the next time you start the app. Profile → “Check for updates” fetches the latest at any time.
- Mark entry keeps your work on the phone if the network drops, and saves it when you are back online.
- Downloads such as report cards, receipts and statements open in your phone’s PDF viewer, ready to share on WhatsApp or print.

CHAPTER 15

Getting help

Most questions are answered on the page itself: many pages have a “How to” panel at the bottom. For anything else, these are the places to go.

15.1 Where to get help

This guide is always available from Help in the menu, and as a PDF you can download and print.

- Your school administrator can add or reset accounts, fix classes and subjects, and change school settings.
- For problems with Skulbase itself, use the contact page at skulbase.com/contact, or call 0740 129 444.
- When you report a problem, say which page you were on, what you pressed and what you expected. A screenshot helps.